



## PROGRESS REPORT

# Regional collaboration: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-10-3 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

54 countries. Each row below is carried verbatim from that country's own progress report, which answers a fixed frame of indicators over the period; nothing is written here. A country not listed under an indicator has **No evidence** on it in its own report.

REGIONAL POLICY COLLABORATION · REGIONAL LEGAL HARMONISATION · SHARED REGIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE ·  
CROSS-BORDER DATA TRANSFERS

**Progress values.** *Movement* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

## Regional policy collaboration

| COUNTRY | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS |
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| Algeria | <p>Algiers <a href="#">hosted two ministerial declarations</a> and the country <a href="#">joined a digital public infrastructure campaign</a> and a world artificial-intelligence body.</p> <p>2025-12-07 - African information and communication technology ministers adopted a declaration on fair, safe and responsible digital platforms, drafted under the African Telecommunications Union and setting founding principles for a common continental framework on over-the-top platforms, including coordinated negotiation with the global platforms and platform contribution to local infrastructure; continental political adoption was expected in early 2026 and nothing establishes it.</p> <p>2026-03-30 - a second Algiers declaration on telecommunications sovereignty and integrated connectivity for 2026-2030 was adopted, and the country joined a digital public infrastructure campaign as its fifteenth African member, confirmed in the state press and in the biometrics press.</p> <p>2026-07-16 - a founding signature at a world artificial-intelligence organisation is reported with no accord text, ratification step or work programme on file.</p> | MOVEMENT |
| Benin   | <p>Ministers <a href="#">adopted a single digital market declaration at Cotonou</a>, the authority <a href="#">signed cooperation conventions with two neighbours</a>, and the country <a href="#">joined a global identity campaign</a>.</p> <p>2025-11-19 — West and Central African ministers adopted a declaration committing to 90% affordable broadband by 2030, interoperable identity and payments, doubled intra-African e-commerce, harmonised cyber, data and artificial-intelligence frameworks, and 20m people with basic digital skills. No implementation report against it has followed.</p> <p>2026-04-17 — the data protection authority signed cooperation conventions with two neighbouring regulators; its president is vice-president of the francophone association and sits on the African network's executive committee.</p> <p>2026-06-02 — the country joined the 50-in-5 digital public infrastructure campaign as its sixteenth African member.</p> <p>All three are commitments rather than instruments. What Benin actually exports is running code: the cross-border identity pilot and the police fingerprint link reported below.</p>              | MOVEMENT |

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS |
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| Botswana     | <p>Two bilateral memoranda <a href="#">were signed in a fortnight – one with Namibia on transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills</a> – with no value or deliverable published for either.</p> <p>2026-08-07 – the two countries' ICT ministries signed at Kasane with their operators and regulators, covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills development, with the accompanying disclosure costing the remaining corridor coverage gaps at about N\$52 million across 13 new sites and recording the two national response teams deepening cooperation, announced two days before and confirmed on the day. No term, funding or data-governance provision is published and the signed instrument is not held.</p> <p>2026-08-19 – the two countries' innovation agencies signed on cross-border innovation and technology commercialisation, framed by both as advancing the region's industrialisation agenda. No value, workstream, deliverable or duration is published.</p> <p>Two memoranda in a fortnight, neither costed, is the shape of this section: the delivered regional work is the roaming agreement and the fibre interconnection reported elsewhere.</p> | MOVEMENT |
| Burkina Faso | <p>Six francophone states <a href="#">adopted common non-binding artificial-intelligence governance guidelines in July 2026</a>, complementary to national strategies.</p> <p>2026-07-06 – common guidelines on artificial-intelligence governance were adopted by six states, led by an advocacy organisation, non-binding and complementary to national strategies. Nothing of the kind existed before, and the text itself is not held.</p> <p>Non-binding guidelines led by an advocacy body are the weakest instrument in this section, and they are also the only multilateral digital-policy act the country joined in the window that is not about identity documents or radio frequencies. The regional commission's own community strategy, reported under artificial-intelligence policy, is the instrument that would carry weight, and it has no timetable.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT |
| Burundi      | <p>Burundi <a href="#">joined the regional One Network Area and ratified the digital integration protocol</a>, and <a href="#">agreed a continental trade implementation roadmap in August 2026</a>.</p> <p>2025-01-21 – the country joined the East African One Network Area and ratified the regional digital integration protocol, where neither applied before.</p> <p>2026-08-03 – a technical team agreed during a continental trade secretariat mission to produce a country profile and implementation roadmap jointly owned by government and the private sector, tied by the minister to the country's African Union chairmanship, with the adjustment fund discussed as a financing route. No roadmap, profile or timetable has been published.</p> <p>2026-07-28 – separately, a telecommunications-technology memorandum with Vietnam reached an implementation meeting, party to party rather than ministry to ministry, producing policy transfer, equipment and scholarships and no monetary commitment, against a memorandum signed in November 2024 with no digital follow-through reported.</p>                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT |
| Cameroon     | <p>A regional expert panel <a href="#">recommended terrestrial gateways inside the region's jurisdiction and citizens' data stored on the continent</a>.</p> <p>2026-02-24 - at the regional regulators' tenth ordinary session an expert panel recommended a satellite data-residency framework: terrestrial gateways inside the region's jurisdiction, operator-equivalent financial obligations, and citizens' data stored on the continent.</p> <p>It is a panel recommendation, not an adopted regional instrument, and no member state has since enacted any part of it on the record. Cameroon's own satellite position - a licence file undecided for two years and a standing seizure circular - sits alongside it without either being reconciled to the other.</p> <p>The central bank adopted a regional financial inclusion strategy for 2025-2029 covering the six member states, validated by the monetary union's ministerial committee on 21 December 2023 and published in February 2025 (strategy); the base holds no member-state implementation plan, target or outturn under it.</p>                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT |
| Cape Verde   | <p>A <a href="#">digital corridor with Nigeria launched in September 2025</a>, and an <a href="#">island-economies programme launched in July 2026</a>.</p> <p>2025-09 - a support agreement was signed in Abuja launching a corridor with cooperation priorities of artificial intelligence, youth empowerment and bilateral development, its declared deliverables training of over 500 secondary students on three islands, science and technology tools in Portuguese with teacher training, and a business and innovation mission in Praia, the mission having been announced at an artificial-intelligence summit. The base holds no record that either deliverable was delivered, and it is promoted by a private organisation rather than by a treaty instrument.</p> <p>2026-07-24 - a programme for African developing island economies launched with a 2026-2031 roadmap covering this and six other island states, on six pillars including connectivity; no country-specific commitment, allocation or project is named.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT |

| COUNTRY                  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | PROGRESS |
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| Central African Republic | <p>The minister <a href="#">met a development-bank delegation on joining the six-country regional digital integration programme</a>; no financing agreement, amount or date is recorded.</p> <p>2026-03-06 — talks were reported on joining the six-country regional programme covering broadband, cross-border interconnection, secure public platforms and digital skills, with no figure, signature or follow-up since. The source is a secondary aggregator with quotes attributed to a wire service and the meeting date is not stated, so participation is reported intent rather than finance.</p> <p>Nothing has followed in five months. The programme is the obvious route to the cross-border interconnection and the secure platform layer the country lacks, and it is the only accession discussion on this ledger.</p> <p>The central bank adopted a regional financial inclusion strategy for 2025-2029 covering the six member states, validated by the monetary union's ministerial committee on 21 December 2023 and published in February 2025 (strategy); the base holds no member-state implementation plan, target or outturn under it.</p> | MOVEMENT |
| Chad                     | <p>A <a href="#">regional financial inclusion strategy for 2025-2029</a> adopted by the central bank covers the member states; nothing in the window moved it.</p> <p>A Chadian delegation drew on the Togolese experience of deploying digital solutions in the agricultural sector (visit). The account is the host government's, and nothing states what Chad will adopt.</p> <p>The central bank adopted a regional financial inclusion strategy for 2025-2029 covering the six member states, validated by the monetary union's ministerial committee on 21 December 2023 and published in February 2025 (strategy); the base holds no member-state implementation plan, target or outturn under it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT |
| Comoros                  | <p>A <a href="#">programme for African island economies launched in July 2026</a> with digital transformation among six pillars.</p> <p>2026-07-24 - the programme was launched at an Abidjan ministerial segment with a 2026-2031 roadmap covering the seven African island states, digital transformation one of six pillars and digital public infrastructure, artificial intelligence and automation named as its accelerators. Ministers adopted a communique committing to it, and it is advanced with a bilateral partner, a development bank, the regional economic communities and the Indian Ocean Commission. No Comorian component, financing figure or national milestone is stated, so nothing on file says what this country undertakes under it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT |
| Congo                    | <p>The <a href="#">two Congolese media regulators agreed to align platform regulation</a>, and a <a href="#">bilateral ICT memorandum was approved on the counterparty's side</a>.</p> <p>2026-08-19 - a round table in Kinshasa agreed alignment on how the two states regulate media and digital platforms, one regulator calling for joint mechanisms across a shared digital frontier and the other pressing for cooperation on online hate speech and disinformation while insisting regulation must not curtail freedom of expression. No instrument was signed.</p> <p>2026-07-27 - a bilateral information-technology memorandum was approved by the counterparty's cabinet and its minister authorised to sign, with no scope, financing, signature date or Congolese step published.</p> <p>A first Central African cybersecurity agencies conference was announced for 2 to 5 June 2026 and nothing records whether it convened.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT |
| Cote d'Ivoire            | <p>Six francophone states <a href="#">adopted common artificial-intelligence governance guidelines</a>, and Abidjan hosted two ECOWAS statistics workshops.</p> <p>Côte d'Ivoire declared its candidacy for election to the ITU Council and will press it at the world telecommunication policy forum in the Bahamas (report).</p> <p>2026-07-06 - common guidelines on transparent and inclusive artificial intelligence, data protection, algorithmic-bias mitigation and digital sovereignty were adopted by six states, complementing rather than replacing national strategies. They are non-binding, and were led by an advocacy organisation rather than by a regional body.</p> <p>2026-08-18 to 22 - Abidjan hosted two regional statistics workshops under the ECOWAS Commission's research and statistics directorate: the sixth Regional Coordination Meeting, which validated the third edition of the Regional Report on International Migration in West Africa, and a capacity-building session for national committees on macroeconomic statistics for the Convergence and Macroeconomic Stability Pact.</p>                                       | MOVEMENT |

| COUNTRY           | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | PROGRESS  |
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| Djibouti          | <p>The country <a href="#">hosted a continental private-sector forum that adopted a Djibouti Declaration on digital trade</a> in December 2025.</p> <p>2025-10-06 - a three-day regional consultation in Arta on an information sharing and analysis centre advanced a regional cyber-threat mechanism aligned to the continental convention.</p> <p>2025-12-08 - the 16th African Union Private Sector Forum, held in Djibouti, adopted the Djibouti Declaration on digital-trade implementation, data-protection and cybersecurity alignment, digital public infrastructure and interoperable payments.</p> <p>2026-06 - senior policymakers joined a regional data-governance workshop in Nairobi drafting harmonised regional data-policy roadmaps.</p> <p>Standing behind these, the regional health data-sharing framework of 2022 is non-binding and its domestication is not evidenced complete.</p> <p>2024-12 - the regional health-data framework produced hardware: computing equipment was handed to the health ministry for three cross-border health facilities, district health offices and the ministry's health information system, under a European Union digital solutions project implemented by a German development agency, distributed across all member states to strengthen regional disease surveillance. No equipment count or value is published.</p>          | MOVEMENT  |
| DR Congo          | <p>The <a href="#">African Telecommunications Union's return to Kinshasa</a> was ratified on 23 July 2026 after arrears were paid.</p> <p>2026-07-23 - the union's seventh Plenipotentiary Conference ratified the return of its headquarters to Kinshasa after arrears were paid, with no date for the move stated, and a bid for an ITU Administrative Council seat for 2027-2030 pending.</p> <p>The arrears figure and the account are the posts and telecommunications minister's own, given marking a year in office, and no union document, decision text or move timetable is held. Hosting a continental body is the clearest regional position the base records for this country in the window.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT  |
| Egypt             | <p>The country <a href="#">chairs the Arab artificial-intelligence governance and quantum computing working groups</a>, elected to two of six.</p> <p>Neither chairmanship existed at the window's opening; the Arab permanent committee for artificial intelligence and emerging technologies was created by ministerial resolution at a session this country hosted in January 2026 and held its first founding meeting in May.</p> <p>2026-07-31 - it was elected chair of the artificial-intelligence governance working group, whose remit is a guidance framework, technical tools and mechanisms for activating the Arab charter for artificial-intelligence ethics, and of the quantum computing working group, whose remit is an Arab quantum strategy and quantum-cybersecurity deployment.</p> <p>The committee is mandated to propose regional agreements and coordinate a unified position - a bloc track running alongside rather than through the continental work.</p> <p>On the continental side the central bank hosts a digital portal for the African financial stability committee, carrying its objectives, mandate and structure, its member central banks, its meeting calendar and working groups, and acting as the publication channel for the African Financial Stability Report and technical papers, its content maintained by the committee secretariat.</p> | MOVEMENT  |
| Equatorial Guinea | <p>The country <a href="#">took part in a regional data governance workshop</a> in June 2026 applying an international toolkit, with no national framework resulting.</p> <p>It was the second such workshop in the Lusophone Africa process (workshop).</p> <p>No commitment, framework or follow-up is recorded from it, and it is the only regional policy process the base holds outside the continental convention and a bilateral accord with one neighbour.</p> <p>The central bank adopted a regional financial inclusion strategy for 2025-2029 covering the six member states, validated by the monetary union's ministerial committee on 21 December 2023 and published in February 2025 (strategy); the base holds no member-state implementation plan, target or outturn under it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | NO CHANGE |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PROGRESS |
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| Eswatini | <p>The King was elected <a href="#">Chairperson of the SADC Organ</a> in August 2026, and Eswatini sits in the ICT ministerials that endorsed the regional digital strategy.</p> <p>The 46th ordinary summit in Durban elected the King Chairperson of the Organ on Politics, Defence and Security Cooperation; no digital or ICT portfolio attaches to the role on the base (communiqué).</p> <p>Eswatini attended the June 2023 ICT ministerial, which endorsed the draft SADC Digital Transformation Strategy and approved the SADC Postal Strategy 2022-2025 (ministerial).</p> <p>Regional data-protection work reaches national practice through the adequacy model in force for cross-border transfers, and technical assistance is funded to connect national systems into a federated regional electronic know-your-customer framework.</p> <p>The pattern is attendance and endorsement. No SADC digital instrument on the base carries an Eswatini implementation date.</p> <p>2026-09-03 - a second regional channel opened: the Digital Cooperation Organization's secretary-general met the ICT minister on accelerating digital transformation, the country presenting 1.76m mobile connections against a population of about 1.3m and 95% fourth-generation coverage. Exploratory talks with no memorandum, work programme or membership step recorded, and the figures are the government's own.</p> | MOVEMENT |
| Ethiopia | <p>Identity cooperation was agreed with <a href="#">Zambia</a> in March 2026, and a three-year <a href="#">memorandum with Mozambique</a> followed in April.</p> <p>The Mozambique memorandum was signed at Addis Ababa on 27 April 2026 between Mozambique's digital transformation agency and the Ethiopian state digital-identity enterprise, and is extendable by consent (memorandum).</p> <p>Under it the Ethiopian side provides digital-identity, pilot, interoperability and joint-cybersecurity support, coordinated through a joint working group (trade account).</p> <p>The Zambian arrangement is recorded only as identity cooperation agreed, with no text, term or scope on the record (Zambia integrator search).</p> <p>A delegation attended the UNDP Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure session of 2-3 September 2026 alongside four other countries, on moving DPI blueprints to execution, verifiable credentials and consented data sharing, and reusable open-source deployment blueprints. No country programme, commitment or deliverable follows from it on the record.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT |
| Gabon    | <p>A <a href="#">candidacy for telecommunications union governance bodies</a> is under review, alongside participation in the African digital ministers' council.</p> <p>The candidacy was reviewed at the ministry's final technical committee of the administrative year, with no body, seat, slate or election date named (technical committee).</p> <p>That is the whole of the record on multilateral policy engagement, and the base holds no position under the African Union convention on cyber security and personal data protection.</p> <p>The central bank adopted a regional financial inclusion strategy for 2025-2029 covering the six member states, validated by the monetary union's ministerial committee on 21 December 2023 and published in February 2025 (strategy); the base holds no member-state implementation plan, target or outturn under it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT |
| Gambia   | <p>The revenue authority <a href="#">convened the continental tax forum's master class</a> at Banjul in July 2026.</p> <p>The forum's executive secretary argued there that digital systems deliver only alongside governance reform, and pressed for a united African position in the United Nations tax convention negotiations (master class, proceedings).</p> <p>It is the country's only convening role in the base, and the argument made at it, that digitisation without governance reform does not raise revenue, is the sharpest external check on the tax-digitisation claims recorded elsewhere on this ledger.</p> <p>The bilateral digital-cooperation memorandum signed at Dakar on 12 June 2026 held its first steering-committee session at Banjul on 29 August 2026, settling four priorities – infrastructure and interoperability, cyber resilience, capacity building and regulatory harmonisation – with rural electronic-government access named among the work (steering committee).</p> <p>No timetable, budget or named deliverable is attached to any of the four priorities, so what the committee has agreed is a list of headings.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT |

| COUNTRY       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS  |
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| Ghana         | <p>The communications minister was <a href="#">confirmed to chair the African Union's ICT technical committee</a> from October 2026, and a joint venture was signed in Accra to build the <a href="#">continental digital trade corridor</a>.</p> <p>The continental trade secretariat and a Ghanaian technology company signed a joint venture in Accra on 31 August 2026 to establish a digital trade corridor to facilitate, track and settle cross-border transactions (agreement), pitched as ending the routing of African payments through third countries (remarks). It is a signed venture, not a system in service.</p> <p>The fifteenth Africa Internet Governance Forum runs at Accra from 2 to 5 November 2026 with youth, parliamentary and preparatory tracks and a regional school on internet governance; session times, venues and speakers were unpublished when the schedule was read (forum schedule).</p> <p>The communications ministry partnered a policy-intelligence platform in August 2026 to bring regulatory-analysis tools to the artificial-intelligence strategy, data-governance work and the coders programme, with no funding, duration or deliverables stated (partnership).</p> <p>A Malawian delegation came to Accra to structure digital-government cooperation under which more than a dozen Ghanaian technology companies would help build its systems, the identity card cited as the reference at more than 19 million holders (delegation), and the cyber security authority reports discussions with the British High Commission on cyber-enabled crime, child online protection and capacity building (discussions).</p> | MOVEMENT  |
| Guinea        | <p>The regulator <a href="#">chairs the African council of regulators</a>, and the continental summit it hosted in November 2025 has closed.</p> <p>Its director-general presided at the council's fifteenth meeting alongside the summit (chairmanship).</p> <p>The summit ran at Conakry from 12 to 19 November 2025 with 42 states and 14 memoranda, and is recorded closed (summit).</p> <p>None of the fourteen memoranda is separately held, so what survives the summit in the base is the hosting and not its output.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT  |
| Guinea-Bissau | <p>Guinea-Bissau <a href="#">joined AUDA-NEPAD's programme for African developing island economies in July 2026</a>, whose roadmap to 2031 includes digital transformation.</p> <p>2026-07-24 — at the ministerial segment in Abidjan, AUDA-NEPAD launched a Programme for African Developing Island Economies covering Guinea-Bissau among seven states, with ministers adopting a communique committing to a 2026-2031 roadmap on six pillars including digital transformation.</p> <p>It is a continental commitment rather than a national action, and no country-level implementation under it is reported. The country's substantive regional work sits elsewhere on this ledger — the ECOWAS biometric credential and the World Bank's West Africa regional digital programme — and neither is an AUDA-NEPAD instrument.</p> <p>No ECOWAS or UEMOA policy instrument adopted domestically appears in the window.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT  |
| Kenya         | <p><a href="#">Eight cooperation agreements with Tanzania</a> were signed in May 2026, under a community treaty in force since 1999.</p> <p>The treaty establishing the East African Community, signed in November 1999 and since amended, is the standing framework for regional policy cooperation (treaty).</p> <p>Eight cooperation agreements with Tanzania were signed in May 2026 to deepen regional integration (agreements).</p> <p>A technical coordination mechanism on border governance was established with the regional development authority and the African Union border programme in September 2025 (mechanism). None of the three accounts names a digital or data instrument among what was agreed.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT  |
| Lesotho       | <p>Lesotho joined the <a href="#">50-in-5 digital public infrastructure campaign</a> as its fourteenth member in May 2024, and no milestone has been reported since.</p> <p>The country joined in May 2024 as the fourteenth member, with civil registration and its integration with digital public infrastructure named as the commitment (joining, profile).</p> <p>No milestone, review or output under the campaign has been reported for the country in the two years since.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | NO CHANGE |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | PROGRESS |
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| Liberia    | <p>US\$361,151.36 in arrears was waived and voting rights restored at the continental telecommunications union in July 2026, after withholding dating to 1982.</p> <p>Current obligations were arranged and the ratification instrument deposited (waiver). Separately the central bank governor proposed shared cybersecurity standards, cross-border incident reporting and supervisory-technology adoption among West African regulators, citing the country's own instant-payment launch as a benchmark; nothing is adopted, funded or scheduled, and the proposal is one governor's rather than the college's position (proposal).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT |
| Libya      | <p>Libya took the chair of the <a href="#">Arab working group on artificial intelligence and digital infrastructure</a>, declared for the <a href="#">ITU Council</a> and signed an <a href="#">audit roadmap with Tunisia</a>.</p> <p>The Arab ministers' executive bureau recorded Libya's allocation of the chair of the working group on artificial intelligence, data and digital infrastructure on 1 August 2026 (allocation). A delegation canvassed the country's ITU Council candidacy bilaterally at the African Telecommunications Union plenipotentiary in Abuja in July 2026 (candidacy).</p> <p>Libya's Audit Bureau and Tunisia's Court of Auditors signed a phased roadmap in Amman on 15 August 2026 covering exchange of expertise, capacity building, digital systems and cooperation on artificial intelligence and its governance; no phase dates, budget or workplan is published (roadmap).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT |
| Madagascar | <p>Madagascar took a citizen-facing administration position to the regional public service assembly (<a href="#">report</a>).</p> <p>Madagascar argued at the regional public service annual general assembly for an administration turned towards citizens (report).</p> <p>Accession to the China-initiated network was approved by the Council of Ministers on 4 August 2026, mobilising the foreign affairs, justice, public-security, digital-development and gendarmerie ministries for cross-border cooperation on online fraud; no founding text, membership list, data-sharing rule or safeguard on what is exchanged is held (accession, editorial).</p> <p>A bill authorising ratification of the United Nations convention was approved by the Council of Ministers and presented to parliament on 28 August 2026, the government citing the international layer needed to investigate cybercrime across jurisdictions (bill); its vote was among the five deferred on 4 September 2026 (deferral), and the signature itself is reported rather than evidenced by a depositary record.</p> <p>Membership of the world artificial-intelligence cooperation body was reported the same week, with no accession instrument, obligation or contribution held (membership).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT |
| Malawi     | <p>A delegation went to <a href="#">Accra to structure digital-government cooperation</a>, the minister <a href="#">urged regional artificial-intelligence investment priorities</a>, and the <a href="#">regulator opened talks with a development agency</a>.</p> <p>The Accra visit was to structure cooperation under which Ghana is to make more than a dozen technology companies available to help build systems and infrastructure, with Ghana's identity card cited as the reference implementation and Malawi bringing a high-coverage identity system, a data centre and a data exchange; no memorandum, budget or timetable is named (visit).</p> <p>At a regional workshop in Lilongwe the minister named agriculture, healthcare, climate resilience, education, financial services and regional trade as bloc investment priorities, framing connectivity, data quality, skills and cybersecurity policy as the precondition; no bloc decision, instrument or envelope follows it (priorities).</p> <p>Regulator talks with a development agency named identity integration with SIM verification, responsible artificial intelligence, data protection and secondary-school skills as priorities, with no memorandum, funding figure or timetable (talks).</p> <p>A delegation attended the UNDP Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure session of 2-3 September 2026 alongside four other countries, on moving DPI blueprints to execution, verifiable credentials and consented data sharing, and reusable open-source deployment blueprints. No country programme, commitment or deliverable follows from it on the record.</p> <p>The delegation completed a two-week learning mission to India, concluded 7 September 2026 (mission).</p> | MOVEMENT |



| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | PROGRESS  |
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| Mali       | <p>Mali was <a href="#">re-elected to the African Telecommunications Union board</a> for 2027-2031, its data-protection authority <a href="#">signed a confederation coordination roadmap</a>, and it remains a <a href="#">Smart Africa member</a>.</p> <p>Re-election to the union board for the 2027-2031 term was recorded at the Abuja plenipotentiary in July 2026 (re-election).</p> <p>The Ouagadougou declaration on the digital economy was adopted at a regional salon in July 2026, recommending that member governments put digital at the centre of national strategies; Mali spoke for the three confederation states (declaration).</p> <p>Membership of the continental smart-cities and connectivity body continues, with skills, cross-border fibre and a possible summit discussed at a ministerial meeting in March 2026 (membership).</p> <p>2025-11-18 - the three confederation data-protection authorities signed an operational roadmap for their coordination framework, the first practical confederation-level mechanism on the record for cross-border personal-data governance; no budget, secretariat or first joint action is published.</p>                                                                    | MOVEMENT  |
| Mauritania | <p>A <a href="#">digital cooperation memorandum with Senegal</a> was signed in January 2025, with no deliverable, workstream or funding under it on record.</p> <p>The memorandum was signed in January 2025 and nothing has followed it into the base (memorandum).</p> <p>It is the only bilateral instrument with a neighbour on file. The country's other recorded international digital engagements run to the Gulf and to European financiers rather than along its own borders.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | NO CHANGE |
| Mauritius  | <p>The country ran two regional tracks in 2026: <a href="#">Indian Ocean governance in April</a> and the southern African summit in August.</p> <p>The government programme for 2025 to 2029 sets regional cooperation as a standing commitment (programme).</p> <p>An Indian Ocean Commission meeting in April 2026 promoted regional cooperation and sustainable governance (meeting).</p> <p>Cabinet noted the southern African bloc's 46th summit in August 2026 (Cabinet). Neither account names a digital instrument, a data-sharing arrangement or a harmonisation commitment among what was agreed.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT  |
| Morocco    | <p>Morocco was <a href="#">elected to the African Telecommunications Union council</a> for 2027-2031 and signed digital instruments with <a href="#">Gabon</a> and <a href="#">Ghana</a>.</p> <p>The seat was won at the union's twenty-sixth plenipotentiary conference in July 2026, on a delegation combining the digital ministry, the regulator and the development agency; the country offered three of its own programmes to other African states at the same conference (election).</p> <p>A protocol with Gabon on digital skills was signed at a Marrakech exhibition in April 2026, with capacity-building commitments directed at Gabon and no value, term or timetable stated (protocol).</p> <p>A statement of intent with Ghana covering digitalisation, open government, artificial intelligence, data governance and exchanges of experts was signed in Rabat in May 2026, again with no value or term (statement).</p> <p>A memorandum with the UN Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia, signed in Rabat in September 2026, establishes a framework for regional cooperation on modernising public administration and advancing digital governance reform. No programme, value or deliverable is stated for it.</p> | MOVEMENT  |
| Mozambique | <p>Two <a href="#">memoranda with Angola</a> and one on <a href="#">digital identity with Ethiopia</a> were signed in 2026, and the <a href="#">United Nations cybercrime convention</a> was signed but not ratified.</p> <p>The two Angolan memoranda cover space-sector cooperation and communications, information technology, information and meteorology (memoranda).</p> <p>The Ethiopian memorandum, signed in Addis Ababa on an initial three-year term, covers digital-identity platforms and authentication, pilot projects, government-system interoperability, technical training and joint cybersecurity policy; its text is not held (memorandum, account).</p> <p>The cybercrime convention was signed at Hanoi in October 2025 and the ratification request was still to be submitted to parliament in December 2025, with no update since (signature).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT  |



| COUNTRY | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PROGRESS |
|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Namibia | <p>Memoranda were signed with <a href="#">Angola</a> and <a href="#">Botswana</a>, and cabinet <a href="#">authorised signature with the Republic of Congo</a>.</p> <p>The Angolan memorandum covers joint events, exchange of expertise and cybersecurity, with no amount or instrument named (Angola).</p> <p>The Botswana memorandum was signed at Kasane in August 2026 between the two ministries with their operators and regulators, covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills; the two sides costed the corridor's remaining 4G gaps at about N\$52 million across thirteen new sites and recorded a completed cross-border fibre link, the first direct one between the operators (Botswana, cooperation).</p> <p>Cabinet approved a memorandum with the Republic of Congo and authorised the minister to sign, with no scope, financing or signature date published (Congo).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT |
| Niger   | <p>Telecommunications cooperation was <a href="#">agreed with Algeria</a>, the three confederation data-protection authorities <a href="#">signed an operational roadmap</a>, and a <a href="#">regional identity interoperability strategy</a> was validated.</p> <p>Cooperation with Algeria was agreed in March 2026 with no programme document or value published (Algeria).</p> <p>A technical mission was received in Ouagadougou in July 2026 with recommendations on authentic documents and document fraud; no alignment for mutual recognition is established (mission).</p> <p>A West African foundational-identity interoperability strategy was validated at Accra in August 2025 with no implementation step published; it sits awkwardly alongside the country's regional-bloc exit (strategy).</p> <p>2025-11-18 - the three confederation data-protection authorities signed an operational roadmap for their coordination framework, the first practical confederation-level mechanism on the record for cross-border personal-data governance; no budget, secretariat or first joint action is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT |
| Nigeria | <p>An <a href="#">Abuja Declaration on meaningful connectivity</a> was adopted with machinery to argue it internationally, and the country leads a <a href="#">digital trade regulators group</a> and a <a href="#">trilateral customs committee</a>.</p> <p>The declaration was adopted at a continental conference in Abuja in July 2026, with machinery to argue the position at the international union (declaration).</p> <p>The country was named lead of a group harmonising market entry, licensing and regulatory cooperation for African digital service firms, with guidelines named as a first output and none published (group).</p> <p>A joint communique with two neighbours committed three customs administrations to a trilateral steering committee on digital interoperability, harmonised procedures and coordinated risk management at two corridors, with no funding, timeline or output published (customs), and an artificial-intelligence and cyber diplomacy unit sits inside the foreign ministry coordinating engagement on emerging technologies (unit).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT |
| Rwanda  | <p>The capital hosted <a href="#">country consultations for a regional artificial-intelligence framework</a> in August 2026, and it adopted a <a href="#">continental declaration</a> in April 2025 whose signatory count is disputed.</p> <p>The consultations ran under a regional body's programme in August 2026 (consultations), and a separate regional policy roadmap was explored at a science conference in March 2026 with no text, timetable or secretariat named (roadmap).</p> <p>The continental declaration was adopted in the capital in April 2025, is non-binding, and its signatory count is disputed across three sources (declaration, uncertainty).</p> <p>One edition of the global summit that produced it has been held (summit). The country's convening record is strong and none of the four instruments has a published output.</p> <p>A delegation attended the UNDP Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure session of 2-3 September 2026 alongside four other countries, on moving DPI blueprints to execution, verifiable credentials and consented data sharing, and reusable open-source deployment blueprints. No country programme, commitment or deliverable follows from it on the record.</p> <p>The delegation completed a two-week learning mission to India, concluded 7 September 2026, examining digital identity, digital payment and data exchange systems (mission).</p> | MOVEMENT |

| COUNTRY               | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS                                                                                     |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sao Tome and Principe | <p>The country is one of seven covered by a <a href="#">programme for African developing island economies</a>, and takes part in a <a href="#">Lusophone data governance workshop series</a> and <a href="#">regional digital governance dialogues</a>.</p> <p>The island economies programme was launched at a ministerial segment in July 2026; it is a seven-state programme and no national commitments beyond the communique are detailed (programme).</p> <p>A second Lusophone data governance workshop was held in June 2026, and the country's specific national content from it is not detailed (workshop).</p> <p>A second webinar in the regional digital governance series covered digital identity as foundational infrastructure, again from a multi-country source with no national content separated out (dialogues). Three regional forums, and in none of them can the base say what this country said or undertook.</p>                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT                                                                                     |
| Senegal               | <p>The digital minister signed the <a href="#">founding agreement of a global artificial-intelligence cooperation body</a> in Shanghai, and no obligation, contribution or ratification step is reported.</p> <p>The founding agreement was signed in July 2026 (membership).</p> <p>Nothing states what membership requires of the country. It sits alongside a presentation of a national artificial-intelligence programme in Tokyo and exploratory talks in Washington and Beijing: the diplomacy is broad and none of it has yet produced an instrument the base can read.</p> <p>The bilateral digital-cooperation memorandum signed at Dakar on 12 June 2026 held its first steering-committee session at Banjul on 29 August 2026, settling four priorities — infrastructure and interoperability, cyber resilience, capacity building and regulatory harmonisation — with rural electronic-government access named among the work (steering committee).</p> <p>No timetable, budget or named deliverable is attached to any of the four priorities, so what the committee has agreed is a list of headings.</p> | MOVEMENT                                                                                     |
| Seychelles            | <p>The country is one of seven covered by a <a href="#">programme for African developing island economies</a>, on a 2026 to 2031 roadmap with digital transformation among six pillars.</p> <p>The continental trade secretariat signed a joint venture in Accra on 31 August 2026 with the same technology company to establish the digital trade corridor (agreement), while the Seychelles memorandum with the two remains under review. The corridor is proceeding through Ghana rather than through Seychelles.</p> <p>The programme was launched at a ministerial segment in July 2026 (programme).</p> <p>No national commitment, allocation or workplan beyond the communique is detailed. It is the same seven-state programme recorded for other island units in this frame, and in none of them can the base say what the individual country undertook.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MIXED<br>the corridor advanced elsewhere while the Seychelles memorandum stayed under review |
| Sierra Leone          | <p>The country attended the <a href="#">inaugural board meeting of a continental health intelligence body</a> in August 2026, and no constitutive instrument, budget or data-sharing arrangement is published.</p> <p>Membership was taken up and the inaugural board meeting attended (membership).</p> <p>Nothing published states what the body does with member states' health data, which is the question a country with no data-protection law in force most needs answered before joining a health information hub.</p> <p>A delegation attended the UNDP Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure session of 2-3 September 2026 alongside four other countries, on moving DPI blueprints to execution, verifiable credentials and consented data sharing, and reusable open-source deployment blueprints. No country programme, commitment or deliverable follows from it on the record.</p> <p>The delegation completed a two-week learning mission to India, concluded 7 September 2026, examining digital identity, digital payment and data exchange systems (mission).</p>                      | MOVEMENT                                                                                     |
| Somalia               | <p>An <a href="#">instrument of ratification for the continental free trade area</a> is to be deposited in September 2026.</p> <p>A government delegation studied labour and employment digital systems in Dodoma (visit), with a stated intent to learn from the wider public-service digitalisation model (report).</p> <p>The secretariat's own release dates the deposit; its standfirst gives 2 September 2026 while its body says only September, and the wider month is what is carried (accession).</p> <p>Accession has digital consequences the release does not address — the country has no e-commerce strategy, no adopted digital transformation strategy and no data-hosting rule — and none of those is named as a precondition anywhere on file.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT                                                                                     |

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | PROGRESS |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| South Africa | <p>Digitised border systems were <a href="#">made a regional chairship priority</a>, and a <a href="#">regional higher education data system</a> was set as an immediate priority to be tested by June 2027.</p> <p>One-stop border posts and digitised border systems were named a priority of the country's regional chairship on 17 August 2026, tied to a corridor trip monitoring system integrating transport, immigration and customs data, to online permitting and operator accreditation, and to the electronic travel authorisation (chairship). The framing is unusually concrete - progress to be measured in border-crossing times reduced rather than agreements signed - but no crossing time, target or timetable is published against it.</p> <p>Agreement on a regional higher education data system was set as one of five immediate priorities at a regional vice-chancellors' meeting in Johannesburg on 31 August 2026, the higher education minister setting the test as students and academics having moved and data being shared by the June 2027 ministers' meeting rather than documents completed (priorities, meeting). No design, host, funding or data scope is stated.</p> | MOVEMENT |
| South Sudan  | <p>A <a href="#">ministerial visit to a continental telecommunications union</a> produced a pledge of collaboration rather than an instrument.</p> <p>The visit was made to the union's regional headquarters in August 2026, and no workplan, contribution or membership status is stated (visit).</p> <p>It is recorded as a pledge rather than an instrument. Against a country whose fibre backbone is untendered, whose spectrum strategy is consultant-led and whose gateway is privately operated, a ministerial visit is the whole of the regional engagement the base can date.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT |
| Sudan        | <p>Sudan carried a <a href="#">resolution at the ITU development conference</a> and opened <a href="#">cooperation with the regional internet registry</a> on exchange points and address resources.</p> <p>The resolution adopted by consensus in Baku on 26 November 2025 creates a formal basis for international technical and financial assistance to rebuild war-damaged telecommunications infrastructure (adoption).</p> <p>At the WSIS Forum in Geneva in July 2026 the minister discussed strengthening internet exchange points, IPv6 expansion and internet-resource development with the regional registry and the Internet Society (meeting).</p> <p>Both are engagements rather than instruments. Nothing yet commits either side to a dated deliverable.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT |
| Tanzania     | <p>Somalia sent a delegation to study the labour digital systems and is seeking the wider e-governance model (visit).</p> <p>A Somali government delegation studied the labour and employment digital systems in Dodoma on 28 August 2026 (visit), and Somalia is seeking to learn from the public-service digitalisation experience more broadly (report).</p> <p>The consultations were held in February 2026; no adoption date, text or national ratification step is on file and the source is held as an excerpt (strategy).</p> <p>The pipeline consultancy was tendered in August 2026 under a European and regional programme; the record is a procurement notice, so it fixes the consultancy stage and nothing about any project it may prepare (pipeline).</p> <p>The country is consulting on a regional artificial-intelligence strategy while its own has missed its release date.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT |
| Togo         | <p>An <a href="#">African centre for coordination and research in cybersecurity</a> is named as the strategic culmination of a bilateral programme, and the country is a founding government of a <a href="#">pan-African language artificial-intelligence coalition</a>.</p> <p>Chad drew on the Togolese experience of deploying agricultural digital solutions (visit).</p> <p>The cybersecurity centre is named in a regional working-group report which gives no host, no date, no budget and no constituting instrument (centre).</p> <p>The language coalition launched at a continental telecommunications conference with the digital ministry a founding government; no national deliverable, budget, dataset commitment or timetable is on file, and the base holds no statement on how it relates to the country's own fifty-language project (coalition, declaration, initiative).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Tunisia  | <p>The country <a href="#">took a continental telecommunications union council seat and chairs an Arab artificial-intelligence working group</a>, and hosted the <a href="#">ninth Arab civil-status conference</a>.</p> <p>The council seat was won at a plenipotentiary conference in July 2026 (seat), and the working-group chair was taken at an Arab permanent committee's inaugural meeting held in the capital, with only the month published for the election date (chair).</p> <p>The civil-status conference closed in the capital in August 2026 with recommendations only: no instrument is adopted, no member-state commitment is stated and the model framework itself is not held (conference).</p> <p>Three regional positions taken in two months, none of which produces an obligation the base can read.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT |
| Uganda   | <p>The country <a href="#">won a four-year seat on a continental telecommunications council</a>, and a <a href="#">harmonised regional framework for artificial intelligence and digital finance</a> was proposed and left out of the signed communique.</p> <p>The seat was won in July 2026 for a four-year term; the council coordinates African positions on spectrum, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence and data governance before the international union (seat, declaration).</p> <p>The harmonised framework was proposed by a monetary affairs committee chair in the capital and is absent from the signed communique; the stated argument for acting regionally is regulatory arbitrage (framework, bloc).</p> <p>A regional artificial-intelligence policy roadmap was explored at a science conference with the country a participant rather than a sponsor (roadmap).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT |
| Zambia   | <p>A national was <a href="#">elected Secretary-General of the continental telecommunications union</a> on the fourth round, and the country gains the secretariat and loses the council seat in the same cycle.</p> <p>The election was won with 21 of 34 votes at a plenipotentiary conference, for a term beginning January 2027 (election, conference).</p> <p>A declaration on meaningful connectivity was adopted at the same conference; it is a regional commitment with no domestic implementing measure in this base (declaration, connectivity).</p> <p>Holding the continental secretariat while the national artificial-intelligence strategy is undated and the data-protection regulator has no recorded action is the shape of this unit's international position.</p> <p>A delegation attended the UNDP Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure session of 2-3 September 2026 alongside four other countries, on moving DPI blueprints to execution, verifiable credentials and consented data sharing, and reusable open-source deployment blueprints. No country programme, commitment or deliverable follows from it on the record.</p> <p>The country hosted the first Africa Digital Parliamentary Summit in July 2025, at which the Pan-African Parliament adopted the Lusaka Declaration on AI, data protection and privacy, committing members to digital literacy programmes for parliamentarians, Africa-led AI governance frameworks and health information exchange protocols. The declaration binds no state and no Zambian follow-up to it is held.</p> <p>The delegation completed a two-week learning mission to India, concluded 7 September 2026 (mission).</p> | MOVEMENT |
| Zimbabwe | <p>A <a href="#">three-day regional data-governance harmonisation workshop</a> was held in the capital, and a <a href="#">bilateral immigration memorandum</a> carried a benchmarking visit on border technology.</p> <p>No outcome document, commitment or timetable from the workshop is held (workshop).</p> <p>The immigration memorandum was signed in 2024 at year precision, its text not held, and a benchmarking visit followed in July 2026 (memorandum).</p> <p>The border system that visit examined is recorded separately, and its transfer to another state runs on that bilateral memorandum and study visits rather than a continental standard.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT |

## Regional legal harmonisation

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS                                                               |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Algeria      | <p>The <a href="#">1989 Maghreb Union treaty</a> is in force with a binding judicial organ and no summit since 1994.</p> <p>The treaty concluded at Marrakesh in February 1989 has been in force since 1 July 1989 and establishes a presidential council, a council of foreign ministers, a general secretariat, a consultative council and a judicial organ whose rulings bind.</p> <p>No summit has been held since 1994, so the instrument supplies a legal frame for harmonisation and no working machinery. Harmonisation between Maghreb states therefore proceeds bilaterally where it proceeds at all.</p>                                                                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE                                                              |
| Benin        | <p>Eight member states <a href="#">approved a draft land registration harmonisation directive</a> in June 2026.</p> <p>The directive approved by ministers at Ouagadougou in June 2026 harmonises the rules governing land registration and property titling across the union, and covers the establishment of land information systems in urban areas.</p> <p>It is an approved draft rather than a transposed rule: nothing in the base records domestic implementation in any member state.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT                                                               |
| Botswana     | <p>Botswana <a href="#">signed the SADC Regional Development Fund operationalisation agreement in March 2026</a>, the clearest regional legal step in the window.</p> <p>2000-08-07 — the SADC Protocol on Legal Affairs constitutes the regional legal sector Botswana harmonises through.</p> <p>2026-03-31 — Botswana signed the agreement operationalising the regional development fund, together with the agreement amending the protocol on finance and investment.</p> <p>2026-08-17 — the 46th summit approved the agreement establishing a regional tourism univisa. No domestication instrument for any of the three is held.</p>                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT                                                               |
| Burkina Faso | <p>Eight member states <a href="#">approved a draft land registration harmonisation directive</a> in June 2026.</p> <p>The directive approved by ministers at Ouagadougou in June 2026 harmonises the rules governing land registration and property titling across the union, and covers the establishment of land information systems in urban areas.</p> <p>It is an approved draft rather than a transposed rule: nothing in the base records domestic implementation in any member state.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT                                                               |
| Burundi      | <p>The regional assembly <a href="#">endorsed a bill creating an East African statistics bureau, with Burundian amendments</a>; the bureau is not on record as established.</p> <p>2025-10-10 — the East African Legislative Assembly endorsed the bill establishing a regional statistics bureau, carrying amendments from Burundi. Nothing existed before it and the bureau is not on record as constituted.</p> <p>It is the only regional legal instrument on this ledger that Burundi shaped rather than joined. The two others — the One Network Area and the digital integration protocol — were acceded to as drafted, and the cross-border data-sharing framework reported below was validated regionally with no national implementing instrument since.</p>          | MOVEMENT                                                               |
| Cameroon     | <p>An <a href="#">interoperable QR-code standard was launched under a regional regulation of 8 April 2026</a>, binding across the six member states.</p> <p>2026-07-29 - the standard was launched at Douala under a regional regulation of 8 April 2026, so that any bank, microfinance or mobile-money application can scan any merchant code across the six member states, routed and settled through the regional switch, validated by the regional ministerial committee in April 2026.</p> <p>It is a regional instrument binding on Cameroonian institutions rather than a national one. No national transposition, compliance deadline or supervisory finding is on file, and no count of Cameroonian merchants or applications on the standard has been published.</p> | MOVEMENT                                                               |
| Cape Verde   | <p>The National Assembly <a href="#">approved accession to the AU Malabo Convention by Resolucao 153/IX/2020</a>.</p> <p>Resolucao 153/IX/2020, gazetted on 17 March 2020, approves accession to the African Union Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection and publishes the Convention's full Portuguese text — the national act by which Cabo Verde harmonises to the regional instrument. What the base does not hold: any act of ratification or transposition of an ECOWAS supplementary act on data protection or electronic transactions, and nothing on accession to Council of Europe Convention 108, which the ledger carries as an open row.</p>                                                                                                   | NO CHANGE<br><br>a standing position the base holds for the first time |

| COUNTRY                  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS  |
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| Central African Republic | <p>A police circular <a href="#">applies community free movement on biometric documents at every border post</a>, admitting community citizens for up to 90 days.</p> <p>A police circular of September 2024 applies the community free-movement rules at every border post, admitting community citizens for stays of up to 90 days on a valid biometric national identity card, community identity card, biometric passport or approved community passport, implementing an additional act of April 2019 on common migration policy. A neighbouring state issued equivalent instructions the same month.</p> <p>Nothing in the window changed it. It is the only instance on this ledger of a regional legal instrument being applied domestically by an operational order, and it depends on documents whose issuance is reported under digital identity as priced informally at one prefecture.</p>                         | NO CHANGE |
| Chad                     | <p>The <a href="#">continental cyber and data protection convention</a> was signed in June 2015 with no ratification and no deposit as at February 2026.</p> <p>The depositary's status list of 2 February 2026 records signature only (status). Eleven years signed and unratified, in a country with no domestic data-protection statute either, means neither the regional nor the national instrument binds anything here.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | NO CHANGE |
| Comoros                  | <p>The <a href="#">African Union data convention is signed and not ratified</a>, eight years on; regional trade instruments are urged rather than adopted.</p> <p>The African Union's own status table of 2 February 2026 gives the Comoros a signature date of 29 January 2018 for the Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection, and dashes in both the ratification and the deposit columns. Nothing on file records a ratification bill, a timetable or a stated position.</p> <p>2025-10 - the twenty-fourth COMESA summit, attended by the Comorian president, urged member states to adopt the electronic certificate of origin, the electronic cargo tracking system, the online non-tariff barriers system and national single windows, and commended progress on the regional digital retail payment platform.</p> <p>What the Comoros has adopted of any of them is not stated anywhere on file.</p> | NO CHANGE |
| Congo                    | <p>The <a href="#">community interoperable QR-code standard went live across the six member states</a> under an April 2026 regulation.</p> <p>2026-07-29 - the standard launched at Douala under an April 2026 regulation, letting any bank, microfinance or mobile-money application scan any merchant code across the six member states, routed and settled through the regional switch.</p> <p>It is a regional instrument the country sits inside rather than one it made. The country is second in the region by mobile-money volume, at 22.76% of it in 2024, and no country-specific adoption figure, merchant count or transposition step is held, so what the standard has changed here is not established.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT  |
| Cote d'Ivoire            | <p>Instant-payment interoperability <a href="#">became compulsory across the monetary union from 30 June 2026</a>, binding every licensed institution.</p> <p>The obligation did not exist at the window's opening. A communique of 2 April 2026 made instant-payment interoperability compulsory across the monetary union from 30 June 2026 for banks, microfinance institutions, electronic-money institutions and payment institutions.</p> <p>It is a regional instrument binding on Ivorian institutions rather than an Ivorian one, which is the pattern for payments here. No account of Ivorian institutions' compliance after the deadline is held, and no supervisory finding, penalty or exemption has been published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT  |
| Djibouti                 | <p>The country <a href="#">signed the United Nations cybercrime convention in Hanoi in October 2025</a>, having ratified the continental convention in 2023.</p> <p>The continental convention on cyber security and personal data protection was ratified in November 2023 and is unchanged.</p> <p>2025-10 - the country signed the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime in Hanoi as one of seventy-one signatories; no ratification instrument is on file.</p> <p>Both are ratified or signed by a state whose own data-protection supervisor is unevidenced, so the harmonisation is at treaty level and has no domestic enforcement body the base can point to.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT  |

| COUNTRY           | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS                                                             |
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| DR Congo          | <p>A <a href="#">regional free-roaming resolution mandating implementation by 30 June 2026</a> passed its deadline with nothing on record.</p> <p>2026-02-24 - regional regulators adopted a resolution mandating effective free roaming across Central Africa by 30 June 2026, at a session hosted in Kinshasa.</p> <p>The deadline has passed with no implementation, tariff or country-specific measure held. Nothing states whether Congolese operators were consulted, what a compliant tariff would look like, or what follows a missed regional deadline; the resolution is the only harmonisation instrument on this ledger and it has produced nothing measurable.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | STALLED                                                              |
| Egypt             | <p>The <a href="#">29th session of the Arab ICT ministers council approved an AI committee and adopted an ethics charter</a> in Cairo.</p> <p>2026-01-22 - the 29th session, hosted by the communications ministry in Cairo, approved the establishment of a regional committee for artificial intelligence and emerging technologies and adopted a regional charter on artificial-intelligence ethics, described as a guiding and advisory document rather than a binding instrument.</p> <p>A guiding charter is harmonisation by persuasion. Nothing records the charter being domesticated here or anywhere, and the country's own national governance framework is separately made and does not cite it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT                                                             |
| Equatorial Guinea | <p>The country <a href="#">signed the continental cyber and data convention</a> on 28 July 2026 and is not a party to it.</p> <p>No instrument of ratification is on file or on the continental register (signature).</p> <p>The Chamber of Deputies' unanimous vote of 25 March 2026 was a domestic authorisation to ratify, taken four months before the country became a signatory, so the two acts ran in the wrong order and the second has not followed (authorisation).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT                                                             |
| Eswatini          | <p>SADC ministers urged <a href="#">ratification of the Malabo Convention</a> in 2019; it reached Eswatini's senators for ratification in July 2026 and is not ratified.</p> <p>The September 2019 ministerial urged member states to consider ratifying the African Union Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection, and approved regional frameworks including mobile broadband gap analysis guidelines and a framework for a regional computer incident response team (ministerial).</p> <p>Seven years later the ICT minister presented Malabo, alongside the Budapest and Tampere Conventions, to senators for ratification (workshop).</p> <p>The one regional instrument the base records as in force domestically is the SADC adequacy model for cross-border data transfers, applying since the Data Protection Act commenced.</p> <p>A regional cybersecurity framework was approved regionally in 2026 with no national implementing instrument recorded.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE<br><br>urged in 2019 and at the presentation stage in 2026 |
| Ethiopia          | <p>Ethiopia completed the validation stage of its continental free trade implementation review, intended to guide domestic regulatory alignment (<a href="#">validation</a>).</p> <p>Ethiopia completed the final validation stage of its African Continental Free Trade Area implementation review in August 2026, using the continental review matrix, intended to guide policy and regulatory reform aligning domestic rules with continental trade commitments (validation).</p> <p>At the third IGAD ministerial conference on labour and migration in October 2025, with Ethiopia's state minister among signatories, the communique welcomed a single visa initiative through harmonised visa systems and recorded that millions of the region's citizens lack legal identification or hold identity documents unsuitable for the digital age (communique).</p> <p>Ethiopia ratified the 2023 IGAD Treaty in April 2024, the operative instrument for its standing in the regional harmonisation framework (ratification).</p> <p>These are commitments to harmonise rather than harmonised rules; the base holds no domestic instrument amended to match a regional one.</p> | MOVEMENT                                                             |
| Gabon             | <p>A draft Code of Civil Procedure would <a href="#">harmonise national procedure with the regional uniform acts</a>, rewriting a 1977 ordinance.</p> <p>A justice ministry commission submitted a draft running to more than 800 pages on 11 August 2026, aligning national civil procedure with the regional business-law uniform acts (draft code).</p> <p>The draft text is not held and no timetable for consultation or introduction is stated, with professional consultation and parliamentary debate still ahead.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT                                                             |



| COUNTRY       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS                                                                                                                                               |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Gambia        | <p>The <a href="#">regional cybersecurity and data protection convention</a> was signed in December 2022 and remains unratified.</p> <p>The ministry's own record of signature on 2 December 2022 states that ratification is still owed, and no instrument of ratification has been published in the four years since.</p> <p>Harmonisation has moved faster in operations than in law: the regulator and its Senegalese counterpart signed a memorandum in December 2025 to implement the regional roaming regulation, with caps and thirty days of free incoming calls from 1 March 2026, and the Information Commission gained full voting membership of the African data protection network in June 2026.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | NO CHANGE                                                                                                                                              |
| Ghana         | <p>A <a href="#">fintech licence-passporting memorandum with Rwanda</a> signed in February 2025 remains unpublished by either central bank.</p> <p>Which licence categories are recognised and on what conditions is therefore unestablished as at July 2026 (memorandum, compliance cost).</p> <p>Separately, an anti-illicit-flows policy tracker piloted here over eighteen months alongside five other states has been endorsed for continental roll-out from diagnostic pilot to standing self-assessment instrument, the finance ministry reporting it contributed to recovering millions of dollars in revenue; no Ghana-specific score, findings or reform list is published (tracker).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE                                                                                                                                              |
| Guinea        | <p>The <a href="#">continental cyber and data convention</a> was ratified by decree in July 2017, and the country took the <a href="#">presidency of the regional audiovisual regulators platform</a> in August 2026.</p> <p>The ratification decree's own gazette publication is held, alongside the promulgation decree for the authorising law, the law itself remaining unheld and cited only by its long title (ratification, promulgation).</p> <p>The African Union's own status list records ratification or accession in July 2018 and deposit in October 2018, and the two sets of dates measure different acts. No domesticating instrument or alignment review has followed in the nine years since.</p> <p>2026-08-31 — the 12th General Assembly of the audiovisual regulators platform of the eight monetary-union states and Guinea opened in Conakry, and its presidency passed to Guinea, the head of the national communications authority taking its leadership. The two-day agenda was harmonising the legal and technical tools for regulating social platforms against cybersecurity and social-cohesion risks, including AI-generated disinformation and deepfakes, and strengthening the standing of regulators over digital platforms. The Justice Minister opened it arguing for a framework that protects without stifling and regulates without censoring, and calling cybersecurity a question of sovereignty rather than a technical one. No harmonised instrument, timetable or funding is announced, so what the base holds is a presidency and an agenda.</p> | <p>MOVEMENT</p> <p>the country took the presidency of the regional audiovisual regulators platform on an agenda of harmonising platform regulation</p> |
| Guinea-Bissau | <p>Eight states <a href="#">approved a draft land registration harmonisation directive</a> in June 2026.</p> <p>Two harmonisation instruments moved in the window. Eight member states approved a draft directive harmonising land registration and titling rules across the union in June 2026, and a Bissau workshop presented the union's paperless customs directive and a trade-document platform in April.</p> <p>On identity, a regional consultation opened on a roadmap from national identification systems to the common biometric card. No domestic transposition of any of the three is recorded.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT                                                                                                                                               |
| Kenya         | <p>The country has <a href="#">neither signed nor ratified the continental cyber and data convention</a>, though the Cabinet approved a process step towards accession in September 2025.</p> <p>The data protection commissioner led national stakeholder consultations closing 6 October 2025 and the formal accession process was still open at January 2026, having stalled twice on cabinet reshuffles after the Attorney-General cleared the Convention; twenty African Union member states had ratified as at March 2026 (policy brief).</p> <p>A high-level parliamentary dialogue on accession was called for 7 September 2026 (dialogue).</p> <p>The base holds no instrument of accession and no parliamentary vote, so what has moved is the process rather than the treaty position.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT                                                                                                                                               |
| Lesotho       | <p>An <a href="#">African Union Data Policy Framework readiness workshop</a> was convened in July 2025, and no assessment or resulting instrument is held.</p> <p>AUDA-NEPAD convened a readiness workshop from 28 to 31 July 2025 on domesticating the framework (workshop).</p> <p>No readiness assessment, legislative review or instrument has followed it into the base, so the domestication is recorded as convened and not as done.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | NO CHANGE                                                                                                                                              |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS  |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Liberia    | <p>The <a href="#">Standards Authority Act</a> grounds the apex standards body expressly in ECOWAS quality-infrastructure instruments.</p> <p>The 2022 Act creating the Liberia Standards Authority cites the ECOWAS quality infrastructure – ECOQUAL, ECOSHAM and Regulation C/REG.19/12/13 – and World Trade Organization technical-barriers obligations as its grounding, which is regional legal harmonisation done through domestic enactment.</p> <p>The February 2026 entry into the ECOWAS free roaming agreement with Ghana and Sierra Leone is the other harmonisation step the base holds, with the regulator stressing that full implementation still had to follow.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | NO CHANGE |
| Libya      | <p>Libya <a href="#">signed the United Nations cybercrime convention in October 2025</a>; neither it nor the 2010 Arab convention is ratified.</p> <p>The Arab League's own tally records Libya as having signed the 2010 convention on information technology offences and never ratified it.</p> <p>The pattern repeated: Libya signed the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime at Hanoi in October 2025 among sixty states, with the anti-corruption authority's head leading the delegation. Where harmonisation does bite it is technical rather than legislative: the standards bodies of Libya and Tunisia concluded the twentieth meeting of their mutual recognition working group in December 2025.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT  |
| Madagascar | <p>The <a href="#">African Union cybersecurity and data protection convention</a> cleared constitutional review in July 2024; no deposit of ratification is held.</p> <p>The Constitutional Court declared the ratification law and the convention itself constitutionally compliant in July 2024 (decision).</p> <p>A regional data-policy workshop in Antananarivo in September 2025 brought southern African regulators and telecommunications bodies together on data-sharing agreements and cross-border harmonisation (workshop), and a statistics workshop in the same period covered ICT measurement (statistics).</p> <p>What the base does not hold is any evidence the instrument of ratification was deposited, or any domestic instrument enacted under the convention.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT  |
| Malawi     | <p>A <a href="#">regional declaration on collaborative regulation</a> was adopted at a Lilongwe summit in April 2026, and a <a href="#">regional AI framework</a> is claimed to be under development.</p> <p>The declaration anchors to an international regulatory maturity framework, sets six shared principles and seven areas of collaborative action, and treats artificial intelligence, satellite, digital platforms and next-generation networks as one emerging-technology frontier; the regional association has not published the text, so the whole account is named-analyst commentary and the seven action areas are nowhere enumerated (declaration).</p> <p>A regional artificial-intelligence strategy and regulatory framework is reported under development with no draft, adoption date or document title beyond the name; the claim is the Malawian ministry's rather than the regional secretariat's, so any statement that the region has such a framework is unestablished (framework).</p> | MOVEMENT  |
| Mali       | <p>A <a href="#">confederation protocol on artificial-intelligence governance</a> was recommended in August 2026 with no text, while <a href="#">ECOWAS membership ended</a> in January 2025.</p> <p>The recommendation was one of the national digital week's sovereignty proposals (recommendation).</p> <p>No text, negotiating mandate or signature is on record. The country's harmonisation work that has actually happened runs through travel and identity document specifications agreed with the same two states, which the base records separately.</p> <p>2025-01-29 - ECOWAS's own statement records that withdrawal became effective that day, setting out only narrow transitional arrangements - passports, trade treatment under the liberalisation scheme, free movement and cooperation with ECOWAS officials - and leaving the post-withdrawal applicability of ECOWAS legal-harmonisation instruments, digital and data-governance acts among them, unresolved.</p>                             | MOVEMENT  |
| Mauritania | <p>The <a href="#">1989 Maghreb Union treaty</a> is in force with a binding judicial organ and no summit since 1994.</p> <p>The treaty concluded at Marrakesh in February 1989 has been in force since 1 July 1989 and establishes a presidential council, a council of foreign ministers, a general secretariat, a consultative council and a judicial organ whose rulings bind.</p> <p>No summit has been held since 1994, so the instrument supplies a legal frame for harmonisation and no working machinery. Harmonisation between Maghreb states therefore proceeds bilaterally where it proceeds at all.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | NO CHANGE |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | PROGRESS                                                                                                |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mauritius  | <p>The regional justice ministers <a href="#">called for signature and ratification</a> of the bloc's legal instruments in June 2026; nothing was ratified.</p> <p>The committee of ministers of justice and attorneys general called for enhanced cooperation and for signature, ratification, accession to and implementation of the bloc's legal instruments (call). Which instruments Mauritius has yet to ratify is not stated in the account, and no ratification is recorded against it.</p> <p>What the country has ratified on the data side is the Council of Europe protocol, in September 2020, which is a different track from the regional one (ratification).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | NO CHANGE                                                                                               |
| Morocco    | <p>The <a href="#">1989 Maghreb Union treaty</a> is in force with a binding judicial organ and no summit since 1994.</p> <p>The treaty concluded at Marrakesh in 1989 supplies a legal frame for regional harmonisation and a judicial organ whose rulings bind, and no summit has been held since 1994.</p> <p>Harmonisation therefore happens elsewhere: through data-protection accession instruments the ledger carries, and through continental cross-border data exchange pilots — a US\$38m hub launched with the development programme in September 2025 to steer artificial intelligence and digital public infrastructure uptake across Arab states and Africa.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | NO CHANGE                                                                                               |
| Mozambique | <p>The <a href="#">regional convention on cyber security and personal data protection</a> was ratified in 2019 and no domestic statute gives effect to it.</p> <p>The ratification is recorded in a single line of a consultancy inception report; no month, instrument of ratification or deposit date is held (ratification).</p> <p>Seven years on, the domestic data-protection statute the convention obliges has not been enacted, so what the country has harmonised is its international commitment and not its law.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | NO CHANGE                                                                                               |
| Namibia    | <p>The regional regulators' <a href="#">legal and policy committee</a> first met at Windhoek in August 2026, and the minister holds a <a href="#">seat on an international artificial-intelligence commission</a>.</p> <p>The committee was constituted and met with artificial-intelligence governance, data governance and protection, digital public infrastructure and regional regulatory harmonisation on its agenda, hosted by the national regulator; no work programme, output or timetable is published (committee).</p> <p>The ICT minister is one of eight Africans on a forty-four member commission, on the convening body's account (seat, declaration).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT                                                                                                |
| Niger      | <p>The <a href="#">continental cyber and data convention</a> was ratified in May 2022 and <a href="#">confederation travel and identity specifications</a> validated in November 2024, while <a href="#">ECOWAS membership ended</a> in January 2025.</p> <p>The convention was ratified on 23 May 2022 (ratification).</p> <p>The three confederation states' security ministers validated harmonised travel and identity document specifications at Bamako and referred them to the heads of state; five passport categories are now issued under them, and the validation date is disputed between held accounts (specifications, validation).</p> <p>2025-01-29 - ECOWAS's own statement records that withdrawal became effective that day, setting out only narrow transitional arrangements - passports, trade treatment under the liberalisation scheme, free movement and cooperation with ECOWAS officials - and leaving the post-withdrawal applicability of ECOWAS legal-harmonisation instruments, digital and data-governance acts among them, unresolved.</p> | MIXED<br>confederation instruments advancing while ECOWAS ones lapse                                    |
| Nigeria    | <p>The <a href="#">regional biometric identity card</a> has been in issue since November 2025, while a peer-reviewed review records the country as a <a href="#">non-signatory to the continental convention</a>.</p> <p>The regional card entered issue in November 2025 to support regional travel and security (card). A peer-reviewed review of health-data governance in four countries records only one of them as a signatory to the continental cyber and data convention, and finds all four frameworks fragmented with weak cross-border transfer harmonisation and capacity gaps (review). A country issuing a regional credential while outside the regional data instrument is the shape here.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MIXED<br>a regional biometric card in issue while the continental cyber and data convention is unsigned |

| COUNTRY               | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS  |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Rwanda                | <p>A <a href="#">bilateral licence passporting memorandum</a> was signed in February 2025 and its text is unpublished, and a <a href="#">second passporting framework</a> was agreed with another neighbour in March 2026.</p> <p>The first memorandum was signed between the two central banks in February 2025 and its text has not been published (memorandum, compliance cost).</p> <p>The second was signed in March 2026; the earlier bilateral memorandum predates it and its text is still unpublished, so a firm cannot read either instrument to find out what passporting actually confers (framework).</p> <p>Two unpublished memoranda are the whole of the regional licensing record, and no firm is reported as having used either.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT  |
| Sao Tome and Principe | <p>The country hosted a <a href="#">regional regulators' workshop on universal connectivity</a> in November 2025, closing on a joint commitment to continued regulatory harmonisation.</p> <p>The workshop was organised by the international telecommunications body with the national regulator and the Lusophone regulators' association, bringing together regulators from the member states, specialists and national technicians on promoting and measuring universal and meaningful connectivity (workshop).</p> <p>The regulator's technical administrator described it as a step towards keeping the country aligned with international best practice, and the meeting closed on a joint commitment to continue technical cooperation and regulatory harmonisation among Portuguese-speaking countries (workshop).</p> <p>No harmonised instrument, model law or transposition follows it in anything held. The page carries no date and the month is inferred.</p>                             | MOVEMENT  |
| Senegal               | <p>Statistical directors-general <a href="#">approved regional methodological guides</a> at a Dakar meeting and named national legal instruments as the follow-through owed, and <a href="#">six states adopted non-binding artificial-intelligence guidelines</a>.</p> <p>The guides were approved at the close of the Dakar meeting, and the directors' own recommendation names adoption of national legal instruments as the step the country owes (guides, harmonisation).</p> <p>The artificial-intelligence guidelines were adopted by six francophone West African states on the margins of a global dialogue. They are led by an advocacy organisation rather than a state or bloc secretariat, with no compliance mechanism, budget or review cycle named (guidelines).</p> <p>Both instruments are agreed at regional level and both leave the binding step to national law that has not been taken.</p>                                                                                      | MOVEMENT  |
| Seychelles            | <p>Seychelles is a founding party to the <a href="#">SADC Treaty</a>, whose Protocol mechanism is the route to regional legal harmonisation.</p> <p>The consolidated 2025 edition of the Treaty names Seychelles among the founding High Contracting Parties and sets out the Community's institutions, areas of co-operation and the Protocol mechanism (treaty).</p> <p>No ratification instrument for any specific digital or data protocol is held, so what can be established is membership of the framework rather than adoption of anything harmonised through it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | NO CHANGE |
| Sierra Leone          | <p>A <a href="#">Nigeria-Sierra Leone Digital Transformation Cooperation Framework</a> was signed in November 2025, naming know-your-customer alignment and ECOWAS-aligned digital trade principles.</p> <p>The framework was signed at a bilateral mission in Freetown on 21 and 22 November 2025, with two technical partnerships and a joint working group on a 30-90-365 day action plan; its stated objectives include alignment of digital know-your-customer standards, shared data and AI governance frameworks, and ECOWAS-aligned digital trade principles (communiqué).</p> <p>The country reports to the ECOWAS Parliament on its domestic position (report), and ratifies regional instruments as they arise - the African Road Safety Charter in September 2025 (charter) and ECOWAS air transport supplementary acts in February 2026 (acts).</p> <p>None of that is harmonisation of digital law. The framework is a cooperation instrument with an action plan, not a binding rule.</p> | MOVEMENT  |

| COUNTRY             | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS                                                      |
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| <b>Somalia</b>      | <p>A regional <a href="#">study to harmonise cybersecurity, data protection and digital identity law</a> was commissioned in May 2024 and nothing on the base reports its output.</p> <p>The terms of reference commission a comparative study and recommendations to harmonise cybersecurity, cybercrime, data protection, digital identity, e-commerce and digital-authentication frameworks across member states, Somalia among them (terms).</p> <p>No report, model law or adopted instrument has been published since.</p> <p>Somalia's own national instruments have moved independently of the process – the data protection regulations in April 2026 and the cybersecurity frameworks in July – with nothing stating how either relates to a regional standard (frameworks).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                | NO CHANGE                                                     |
| <b>South Africa</b> | <p>South Africa is <a href="#">recorded as a non-signatory to the Malabo Convention</a> in an August 2026 review, which finds regional frameworks fragmented and cross-border harmonisation weak.</p> <p>2026-08-14 – a peer-reviewed review of health-data governance across four countries records only one of them as a Malabo Convention signatory, and South Africa as a non-signatory. It finds all four frameworks fragmented, with weak cross-border transfer harmonisation and capacity gaps.</p> <p>The position is a standing one restated, not a change: nothing in the window records a ratification step, a cabinet memorandum or a stated intention either way. What the review adds is that the absence is not peculiar to South Africa but is the regional norm, which is the more useful half of the finding.</p>                                                                                                                                       | NO CHANGE                                                     |
| <b>South Sudan</b>  | <p>A <a href="#">Smart Africa declaration of trust</a> was signed in May 2025, committing to cooperation on the digital economy, cybersecurity and artificial intelligence.</p> <p>The declaration is the country's own signed act on regional digital cooperation, announced by the ICT ministry (declaration).</p> <p>The regulator carried the same theme to a regional panel in November 2025 on data governance and sovereignty (panel).</p> <p>Neither is harmonisation of law. No regional instrument has been transposed, and the domestic statutes that would carry a harmonised rule - data protection, electronic transactions - do not exist.</p> <p>A three-day workshop on domesticating the African Union Data Policy Framework was convened in Juba for 8 to 10 September 2026 by the African Union Commission, AUDA-NEPAD, GIZ and KICTANet. Nothing establishes an outcome, a workplan or that domestication has been adopted as government policy.</p> | MOVEMENT                                                      |
| <b>Sudan</b>        | <p>A regional <a href="#">cybersecurity harmonisation consultancy was awarded</a> at USD 336,700, moving the work from terms of reference to an appointed consultant.</p> <p>The regional body's 2025 procurement disclosure records the award of a USD 336,700 consultancy for the harmonisation of cybersecurity legal frameworks across member states, Sudan among them (disclosure).</p> <p>That is a step, not an outcome: the award commits a consultant, not a member state. No harmonised instrument, model law or timetable has been published.</p> <p>Sudan's own cybersecurity draft law is separately in redrafting, and nothing on the base connects the two processes.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT                                                      |
| <b>Tanzania</b>     | <p><a href="#">All eight partner states reaffirmed a shared data-governance agenda in May 2026</a>; the project's own report finds nothing delivered.</p> <p>All eight East African Community partner states reaffirmed at the regional digital integration project's third steering committee in May 2026 their commitment to inclusive regional data-governance frameworks supporting secure cross-border data flows.</p> <p>Part V of Tanzania's own 2022 data protection statute sets the national transborder regime that any harmonised framework would have to meet, requiring an adequacy assessment and commission-authorized safeguards.</p> <p>A reaffirmation is not an instrument. No harmonised regional legal text, mutual-recognition arrangement or adequacy decision between partner states appears anywhere in this base.</p>                                                                                                                          | NO CHANGE<br>commitment reaffirmed and no instrument produced |
| <b>Togo</b>         | <p><a href="#">Transposition of the regional consumer-protection directive</a> has reached consultation only, a stakeholder workshop in March 2025 with no adoption instrument.</p> <p>The source's headline says the framework was adopted and its body describes a workshop; the base has already corrected that (workshop).</p> <p>Nothing since. The consumer-rights outreach tour recorded separately runs on the regulator's existing powers rather than on a transposed directive.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE                                                     |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS  |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Tunisia  | <p>The <a href="#">1989 Maghreb Union treaty</a> is in force with a binding judicial organ and no summit since 1994.</p> <p>The treaty concluded at Marrakesh in February 1989 has been in force since 1 July 1989 and establishes a presidential council, a council of foreign ministers, a general secretariat, a consultative council and a judicial organ whose rulings bind.</p> <p>No summit has been held since 1994, so the instrument supplies a legal frame for harmonisation and no working machinery. Harmonisation between Maghreb states therefore proceeds bilaterally where it proceeds at all.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE |
| Uganda   | <p>Harmonisation rests on the <a href="#">1999 Community treaty</a>; under it a <a href="#">regional framework for AI and digital-finance regulation</a> and an <a href="#">AI policy roadmap</a> are in train.</p> <p>The legal base is the Treaty for the Establishment of the East African Community, signed in November 1999 and in force since July 2000, which binds partner states to cooperate and harmonise in telecommunications and related regulatory fields. It has not moved; what moves under it is programme work.</p> <p>A harmonised regional framework for artificial intelligence and digital-finance regulation is in preparation, and a regional artificial-intelligence policy roadmap sits beside it.</p> <p>None of this is yet law in Uganda. The base holds no domestic instrument transposing a regional digital framework, and no timetable for one.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT  |
| Zambia   | <p>The continental convention on cyber security and personal data protection is <a href="#">signed, ratified and deposited</a>.</p> <p>The African Union's own treaty status table records signature on 29 January 2016, ratification on 15 December 2020 and deposit on 24 March 2021 of the convention on cyber security and personal data protection.</p> <p>It is the clearest binding regional legal-harmonisation instrument the country has joined, and the base holds nothing downstream of it: no domestic measure attributed to the convention, no report under it, and no regional body's assessment of Zambian compliance. Ratification is where this record stops.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE |
| Zimbabwe | <p>Zimbabwe hosted the <a href="#">SADC cluster ministerial</a> in June 2026 and its regulator was nominated to lead regional data-protection capacity building for 2026.</p> <p>Ministers responsible for transport, ICT, information and meteorology met in Bulawayo on 26 June 2026, where the secretariat reported steady progress in implementing the SADC Digital Transformation Strategy among the region's standing frameworks (ministerial).</p> <p>Southern African regulators, data-protection authorities and the region's own bodies met in August 2026 on harmonising data governance, and the Zimbabwean regulator was nominated by SADC to lead regional data-protection capacity building through 2026 (nomination).</p> <p>The President sat as vice-chairperson of the COMESA Authority at its twenty-fourth summit in October 2025, which commended progress on the COMESA digital retail payment platform and named Zimbabwe as host of the twenty-fifth summit (communique).</p> <p>Zimbabwe's own transborder provisions sit in the Cyber and Data Protection Act; no accession to a continental data-protection convention is held.</p> | MOVEMENT  |

## Shared regional infrastructure

| COUNTRY | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | PROGRESS |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Algeria | <p>Three strategic trans-Saharan projects were discussed at the highest level with Niger, both capitals reaffirming their commitment to realising them (<a href="#">report</a>).</p> <p>Three strategic trans-Saharan projects were discussed at the highest level with Niger, both capitals reaffirming their commitment to realising them (report). No timetable or financing is stated.</p> | MOVEMENT |

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | PROGRESS |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Angola       | <p>A neighbouring state operator <a href="#">began proof-of-concept testing on the Angolan satellite</a>, a first step toward selling national space capacity across the region.</p> <p>2026-08-25 — Mozambique's state operator began proof-of-concept testing of the Angolan satellite for telecommunications services in Mozambique, announced by the Angolan telecommunications ministry as a step towards a commercial agreement to distribute communication and broadcasting signals over Angolan space infrastructure.</p> <p>It follows the Mozambican public broadcaster's own proof of concept transmitting its television signal via the satellite, implements a bilateral memorandum signed in June 2026, and runs in parallel with a commercial pilot agreement with a Namibian operator for satellite-driven backhaul. Both trials are framed as advancing the ICT priority of the regional infrastructure master plan.</p> <p>No commercial terms are published, and neither trial has yet become a contract. This is the only case on the ledger of the country exporting digital infrastructure rather than importing it.</p> | MOVEMENT |
| Benin        | <p>Free roaming with two neighbours <a href="#">went live in April 2026</a>, and a fingerprint system <a href="#">was wired to the regional police data exchange</a>.</p> <p>2026-04-24 — community free roaming with Senegal and Togo went live under the regional regulation, with free incoming calls for 30 days, where none existed before.</p> <p>2025-09-30 — a fingerprint identification system was inaugurated and connected to the regional police data exchange, European Union-funded and implemented through Interpol.</p> <p>The two are the useful shape of regional integration on this ledger: a tariff instrument that reaches subscribers directly, and a biometric link between police forces that reaches them without their knowledge. No data-protection instrument governing the second is on file.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT |
| Botswana     | <p>Regional roaming <a href="#">was extended to six states with cuts of between 10% and 98.6%</a>, and a <a href="#">bid to host the regional internet exchange reached the final two</a>.</p> <p>2026-03-13 — the One Network Area was extended to five further states, making six, with roaming cuts of between 10% and 98.6%, data roaming to one neighbour down by up to 94% and incoming messages free across participants, against reduced rates with a single neighbour before. Engagement with one further state is stated as ongoing.</p> <p>2025-11-27 — a bid to host the regional internet exchange was shortlisted to the final two, and no award decision is on record in the eight months since.</p> <p>Roaming is the one regional instrument in this report that reaches a citizen's bill directly, and it is also the one with a published effect.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT |
| Burkina Faso | <p>A frequency coordination protocol <a href="#">was signed with three neighbours in November 2025</a>, and a <a href="#">regional incident response centre was named as a 2026 ambition</a>.</p> <p>2025-11-21 — a protocol with three neighbours set preferential frequencies for operators, interference-prevention mechanisms and 15 km coordination zones either side of the borders, signed alongside a separate free-roaming agreement and following cross-border interference with one of them earlier in the year. No baseline was held.</p> <p>2026-03-23 — a regional incident response centre was announced as an ambition for the confederation, with no host, financing or timetable stated, alongside a stated intention to pool digital infrastructure across it.</p> <p>The identity card reported under digital identity is the confederation's one delivered shared asset; everything else at that level is a communicate.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT |
| Burundi      | <p>Submarine access <a href="#">runs through neighbouring countries with cross-border fibre interconnection</a>, and a <a href="#">regional roaming framework is under development</a>.</p> <p>The regulator's own indicators report brings the position together: submarine cable access to EASSy, SEACOM and TEAMS through neighbouring countries, national backbone cross-border interconnection points with Rwanda, the Democratic Republic of the Congo and Tanzania, and regional roaming. A landlocked country's international capacity is its neighbours' landings, and that is what this row records.</p> <p>2026-05-25 to 29 — regional engagements opened development of a harmonised regional mobile roaming framework under the single digital market agenda, a framework-development milestone rather than an adopted tariff.</p> <p>2026-06-23 to 24 — Burundi endorsed shared regional digital infrastructure, harmonised data-exchange frameworks and digital trust for interoperable cross-border public services at the regional development forum.</p>                                                                     | MOVEMENT |



| COUNTRY                  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS  |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Cameroon                 | <p>The <a href="#">Chad border fibre memorandum</a> was suspended on sovereignty grounds and <a href="#">regional free roaming</a> missed its <a href="#">June 2026 deadline</a>.</p> <p>A cooperation agreement of May 2025 promised the Chad border section within fourteen days. It is not built: the April 2025 memorandum was suspended by Chad's regulator on digital-sovereignty grounds and the parties told to revise and re-sign. Cameroon is Chad's only submarine-cable entry point, so the suspension is a regional connectivity fact rather than a bilateral one.</p> <p>A resolution mandating effective free roaming by 30 June 2026 passed its deadline with no record of implementation; Cameroon's regulator was in the adopting delegation.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | REGRESSED |
| Central African Republic | <p>A community interoperable payment-code standard <a href="#">launched in July 2026 across the six member states</a>, and a <a href="#">regional data-centre programme names a facility here</a>.</p> <p>2026-07-30 — the regional central bank and the payments body launched an interoperable payment-code standard binding across the six member states, routed and settled through the regional switch and secured to card-industry standards. No country-specific adoption step is on file, and the country's share of regional payment volume was 0.43% in 2024.</p> <p>2026-08-25 — a regional programme at definition stage, 25% progress, plans six new data centres across the community including one here, alongside reinforcement of five existing centres, at a stated total of US\$9.00m across eleven countries. The prospectus states a programme total rather than a country allocation.</p> <p>Both are cases of the region supplying what the country has not built: there is no national data centre, reported under storage, and no domestic payments standard on this ledger.</p> | MOVEMENT  |
| Chad                     | <p>The <a href="#">regional free-roaming deadline of 10 February 2026</a> was missed, and the Commission was tasked with building a sanctions mechanism.</p> <p>A regional regulators' workshop hosted in December 2025 set a common framework for a regional fibre-mapping platform, a digital financial services security clinic and a free-roaming deadline of 10 February 2026 with a direct interconnection link mandated and sanctions for non-compliance (workshop).</p> <p>At the 45th ordinary session of the union's council of ministers in Brazzaville on 13 June 2026, formal notice was recommended against operators and regulators delaying full free roaming and the Commission was tasked with building a sanctions mechanism — so the deadline was missed (session).</p> <p>The fibre behind it is older: a 30 million dollar grant and credit financed Chad's leg of the regional backbone under a public-private partnership (financing).</p>                                                                                                                                        | STALLED   |
| Comoros                  | <p><a href="#">Comores Cables signed a memorandum with Angola Cables at AfricaCom on 11 November 2025</a>, extending partnerships beyond the Indian Ocean links.</p> <p>The standing position is three submarine systems reached through one state vehicle: EASSy operational at Grande Comore since May 2011, FLY-LION3 reaching Moroni in 2019 and linking to Mayotte, and Africa2 coming ashore on 12 January 2023, all through the Comores Cables company created by decree in July 2013. The same completion report records that the regional programme's planned internet exchange point was not established, for want of operator commitment, and that no shared regional data centre involving the Comoros was found.</p> <p>2025-09 - a two-day technical workshop with Angola Cables identified cable extension, an exchange point and the security of a regional data centre as the areas to work on.</p> <p>2025-11 - the memorandum was signed. No value, term or work programme is stated.</p>                                                                                              | MOVEMENT  |
| Congo                    | <p>The <a href="#">Central African Backbone appraisal</a> is the founding instrument, and the national data centre is framed as <a href="#">serving the sub-region</a>.</p> <p>The founding instrument for participation in shared regional digital infrastructure is the Central African Backbone appraisal.</p> <p>2025-10-29 — the national data centre was presented as serving countries of the sub-region, which is an intention rather than a signed hosting arrangement with any neighbour.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT  |

| COUNTRY           | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | PROGRESS                                                                                                                   |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cote d'Ivoire     | <p>The <a href="#">West African police information system reaches 105 interconnected sites</a>, while its appropriation fell 23% for FY2026.</p> <p>The government's 2011-2025 security record states 105 processing sites across the judicial and investigative services interconnected under the West African Police Information System. It is a self-report, and no independent account of the system operating in the country is held.</p> <p>The budget moved the other way: FCFA 1,300,000,000 was appropriated for FY2025 against FCFA 1,000,000,000 for FY2026, a 23% cut.</p> <p>2026-07-31 - the ministry visited the regional satellite body, intending to route regional satellite capacity through the universal-service bodies for areas terrestrial infrastructure serves poorly; no terms, tariff or timetable are stated.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <p><b>MIXED</b></p> <p>the regional police system reached 105 interconnected sites while its appropriation was cut 23%</p> |
| Djibouti          | <p>A <a href="#">tripartite agreement for a terrestrial fibre corridor to Ethiopia and Sudan was signed on 4 February 2026</a>.</p> <p>2025-08-28 - the national operator announced a southward extension of its regional express cable from Mombasa to Durban, with new landings in Tanzania, Mozambique, Madagascar and South Africa, service-ready 2028.</p> <p>2026-02-04 - the Ethiopian, Djiboutian and Sudanese operators signed a tripartite agreement for the Horizon Fiber corridor, a terrestrial multi-terabit route connecting the Djiboutian and Sudanese landing stations through Ethiopia, building on a December 2024 memorandum.</p> <p>The operator's own account puts 13 submarine cable systems, ten of them operational, reaching 90 countries. Neither new route carries a stated capacity price or access condition for neighbouring states on file.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <p><b>MOVEMENT</b></p>                                                                                                     |
| DR Congo          | <p>A <a href="#">fibre route linking Goma to Mombasa was reported lit</a>, and a <a href="#">cable across Lake Tanganyika to Tanzania</a> is to be fast-tracked.</p> <p>2026-02 - the route was reported lit, tying eastern DR Congo into the East African terrestrial corridor to the Indian Ocean.</p> <p>The event date is not separately established from the publication date and both held accounts are trade press. No capacity, pricing, operator agreement or traffic figure is published, and the route serves the same eastern provinces where mobile and internet service has been cut for months at a time, so what it delivers on the ground is not established by anything on file.</p> <p>2026-09 - the two foreign ministries reaffirmed that they would fast-track a fibre-optic cable from Kigoma to Kalemie through Lake Tanganyika, alongside a railway link through Burundi and a joint economic commission. No route survey, cost, financing or delivery date is published, and no Congolese ministry statement is on file.</p> <p>The 2,000-kilometre Goma-to-Mombasa terrestrial route through Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi was announced live and carrying traffic on 9 September 2026, with access to subsea capacity at Mombasa (route).</p> | <p><b>MOVEMENT</b></p>                                                                                                     |
| Egypt             | <p><a href="#">2Africa lands at two Egyptian coasts joined by trans-Egypt routes</a>, and a <a href="#">point of presence opened at a Jordanian hub</a>.</p> <p>The transit position is stated in figures: click-to-order cross-connectivity between the 14 subsea systems landing at ten cable stations, linked over ten terrestrial routes.</p> <p>2025-11-19 - 2Africa lands at Ras Ghareb on the Red Sea and Port Said on the Mediterranean, the two joined by two trans-Egypt routes adjacent to the canal.</p> <p>2025-09-22 - a new point of presence at a Jordanian digital hub, paired with a subsea cable and a 15-kilometre link from a Sinai landing point opened a second-country interconnection, and a binding offer valued the regional data hub at US\$230m rising to US\$260m.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <p><b>MOVEMENT</b></p>                                                                                                     |
| Equatorial Guinea | <p><a href="#">Three accords with Gabon</a> were signed in November 2025 covering fibre interconnection, free roaming and frequency coordination.</p> <p>No traffic or tariff figure is published (accords).</p> <p>The July 2026 connectivity plan separately names a zero-roaming arrangement with four neighbours, so the roaming half of the accords has a stated regional extension and no measurement at either end.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <p><b>MOVEMENT</b></p>                                                                                                     |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | PROGRESS                                                           |
|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Eritrea  | <p>Regional planning still treats Eritrea as a gap: cable and data-infrastructure projects carry no commitment to serve Asmara (<a href="#">overview</a>).</p> <p>A regional digital development overview records that planned submarine and festoon cable and regional data-infrastructure projects lack a commitment to serve the region as a whole, including Asmara (<a href="#">overview</a>).</p> <p>The regional infrastructure master plan treats Eritrea as a connectivity gap whose interconnection to Sudan, Ethiopia or submarine landing points should be implemented in the short term – language describing a planned solution rather than an existing connection, and Eritrea is not listed as an existing landing point (<a href="#">master plan</a>).</p> <p>Six years on from that plan the base still holds no cable landing and no cross-border interconnection.</p>                                                                                        | NO CHANGE                                                          |
| Eswatini | <p>A <a href="#">cross-border backbone route</a> to Maputo and onward to undersea cable at Cape Town is the one shared regional asset the base records Eswatini using.</p> <p>The universal access fund and the national backbone operator built an alternative cross-border route to Maputo over powerline fibre, reaching undersea-cable access at Cape Town, in response to frequent backbone and internet failures (<a href="#">programme</a>).</p> <p>A subsea cable system for the Indian Ocean Basin was announced in September 2025 and framed by its operator as a gateway for landlocked southern African and east African markets to reduce reliance on single routes (<a href="#">announcement</a>). No Eswatini commitment to it is held.</p> <p>International capacity on the national backbone stands at 72 Gbps.</p> <p>For a landlocked country every route is somebody else's infrastructure, and the base holds one operating route and one announcement.</p> | NO CHANGE<br>one operating cross-border route and one announcement |
| Ethiopia | <p>A terrestrial corridor with Djibouti, Sudan and Saudi Arabia <a href="#">entered active deployment</a> in August 2026, having become binding in February.</p> <p>The December 2024 memorandum between the three national operators became a binding agreement in February 2026 (<a href="#">binding agreement</a>).</p> <p>By August the end-to-end solution architecture was finalised and site-material procurement complete, with the stated route extended to Jeddah (<a href="#">deployment</a>).</p> <p>No route length, cost, in-service date or transit-revenue projection is published, so the transit-hub claim rests on the corridor's geography alone, and one of the four territories it crosses is at war.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT                                                           |
| Gabon    | <p><a href="#">Three accords with Equatorial Guinea</a> were signed in November 2025 on fibre interconnection, free roaming and radio-frequency coordination.</p> <p>The two digital-economy ministers signed at Mongomo on 13 November 2025 (the accords).</p> <p>No commencement date, link capacity, tariff or coordination schedule is published, so what is held is three signatures and nothing about what has run under them since.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT                                                           |
| Gambia   | <p>A <a href="#">regulatory cooperation and free-roaming agreement with Senegal</a> was signed in June 2026, adding to a three-country roaming memorandum of 2025.</p> <p>The Senegal agreement covers telecommunications regulatory cooperation and free roaming, with no commencement date or tariff published (<a href="#">agreement</a>).</p> <p>A roaming memorandum with Liberia and Sierra Leone signed in February 2025 is unchanged, with no tariff, traffic or commencement figure published (<a href="#">memorandum</a>).</p> <p>Two roaming instruments in eighteen months and no traffic or price figure for either is the position: the agreements are signed and their effect is unmeasured.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT                                                           |
| Ghana    | <p>A <a href="#">three-country identity pilot</a> would recognise a digital identity issued in one state in the other two, and a frequency agreement was finalised with Burkina Faso.</p> <p>The pilot runs with Rwanda and Benin, presented as the first step to a single African digital market by 2030 with eighteen further countries said to be joining, and is run through a continental alliance with German development cooperation; no scale, service, date or governing instrument is stated (<a href="#">pilot</a>).</p> <p>A cross-border frequency coordination agreement with Burkina Faso was finalised in August 2025 with agreed signal-strength thresholds in response to consumer interference complaints, and nothing has been filed since on the thresholds set or compliance with them (<a href="#">agreement</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT                                                           |

| COUNTRY       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | PROGRESS  |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Guinea        | <p>A <a href="#">free-roaming protocol with Sierra Leone</a> was signed in November 2025, on a border interconnection raised to 100 Gbps.</p> <p>The protocol was signed at the regulators' council meeting; no implementation date or tariff is on file (protocol).</p> <p>The backbone interconnection between the two countries was raised from 42.5 Gbps to 100 Gbps under a 2024 bilateral pact (interconnection).</p> <p>The capacity is the base's only measured piece of regional infrastructure, and no traffic figure across it is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT  |
| Guinea-Bissau | <p>The ECOWAS biometric identity card <a href="#">reached its first reported field issuance</a>, 262 cards to women cross-border traders in Sao Domingos.</p> <p>2026-03-16 — the National Borders Commission issued 262 ECOWAS biometric identity cards to women cross-border traders in Sao Domingos, Cacheu, under a Guinea-Bissau-Senegal mobility project backed by ECOWAS and financed by GIZ. It is the first field distribution the base records.</p> <p>The standing position is that Guinea-Bissau is one of six ECOWAS states to have fully operationalised the credential, so what moved in the window is use rather than adoption.</p> <p>The only other shared regional asset on the ledger is the ACE submarine cable, reported under international bandwidth. No regional data centre, internet exchange point or interconnection arrangement appears.</p> | MOVEMENT  |
| Kenya         | <p>Four states <a href="#">opened a joint account</a> to fund a feasibility study for a regional communications satellite, with deposits due 30 September 2026.</p> <p>The account takes partner-state contributions under a roadmap settled at an April 2026 meeting, and neither the study's cost nor each state's share was disclosed (joint account).</p> <p>On terrestrial infrastructure the cross-border link with Tanzania was launched in July 2026, integrating the neighbour's backbone with the Mombasa landings (link).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT  |
| Lesotho       | <p>Lesotho is a <a href="#">founding pilot country of the regional settlement system</a> and hosts the <a href="#">regional cyber drill</a>.</p> <p>2023-11-08 — Lesotho is named one of four founding pilot countries of the regional real-time gross settlement system.</p> <p>2025-08-25 — a partnership was announced to build a federated regional identity-verification arrangement, on a validated Lesotho-South Africa pilot.</p> <p>2025-11-04 — Lesotho hosted the sixth regional cyber drill and announced joining the Smart Africa Alliance.</p> <p>A small landlocked economy reaches shared infrastructure it could not build alone; what the base does not hold is any figure for what Lesotho contributes to or draws from it.</p>                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT  |
| Liberia       | <p><a href="#">Free roaming with two neighbours</a> has run since May 2025, and spare fibre on a four-country power grid is agreed for commercialisation.</p> <p>The roaming arrangement puts a home module at local rates across the three countries, with no traffic or price data published (roaming).</p> <p>Regional consensus was reached in June 2026 to commercialise spare fibre on the shared transmission grid across four countries, which would give the country its first terrestrial redundancy against sole reliance on one submarine landing; no operator, tariff or date is published (grid fibre).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT  |
| Libya         | <p>The <a href="#">Medusa submarine cable</a> reaches Libya through Misrata as part of an eight-country Mediterranean system; no further landing has been recorded.</p> <p>Medusa was inaugurated at Misrata in May 2025 as an 8,700 km system serving Italy, Spain, Portugal, Morocco, Tunisia, Greece, Egypt and Cyprus, with Tripoli and Benghazi landings planned (inauguration).</p> <p>Nothing has been published since on either planned landing, so the country's share of a regional system remains a single station.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | NO CHANGE |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | PROGRESS                                                                                                                        |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Madagascar | <p>Madagascar lands on <a href="#">four shared subsea systems</a>; the window's financing event committed to other markets.</p> <p>The operator confirmed the 2Africa landing at Mahajanga alongside existing participation in the EASSy, LION and METISS systems (statement).</p> <p>A EUR 170 million development bank facility for the group's multi-country network modernisation was reported in June 2026 (financing).</p> <p>The facility's stated recipient countries are Kenya and Senegal; no Madagascar-specific commitment is stated in it. A separate cable extension to Madagascar remains in development (extension).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | NO CHANGE                                                                                                                       |
| Malawi     | <p>The <a href="#">national data centre was completed and the first client systems migrated</a> under the regionally coordinated programme.</p> <p>2025-10 - the acceleration project's implementation report, archived 3 October 2025, records 19 per cent disbursement and completion of the Lilongwe national data centre with first-client migration, under the regionally coordinated digital economy programme.</p> <p>2025-12 - the ministry reported 4,000 kilometres of fibre laid and the government wide area network extended to more than 530 ministries, departments and agencies.</p> <p>The standing shared asset is the regional settlement system: its April 2026 statistics record nine Malawian banks and 1,210 settled transactions. Nothing on file states what Malawi contributes to any shared facility as against what it draws from one.</p>                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT                                                                                                                        |
| Mali       | <p>The three confederation states <a href="#">signed a frequency coordination agreement</a> in November 2025; the <a href="#">regional fibre programme's own page</a> says nothing of the country after its withdrawal.</p> <p>The agreement was presented as a decisive step for regional digital integration, and the three states' digital ministers carried a common position to the union's digital forum in July 2026 (agreement, forum). No band plan, cross-border interference arrangement or implementation date is published.</p> <p>The body the country withdrew from in January 2025 still runs a regional fibre programme, and neither its page nor anything else states what the withdrawal leaves of the country's participation (programme) – the question the withdrawal raises for connectivity, unanswered on the record.</p>                                                                                                                                                     | MIXED<br>a frequency agreement signed while the country's place in the regional fibre programme went unstated                   |
| Mauritania | <p>A vendor with two European donors was <a href="#">named for Sahel digital connectivity support</a> in June 2026, with no site, capacity or delivery figure for the country published.</p> <p>The announcement names an equipment vendor working with two European government funders on Sahel connectivity (announcement).</p> <p>No Mauritanian site, capacity or delivery figure is published, so the country appears in a regional programme whose national share cannot be established.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT                                                                                                                        |
| Mauritius  | <p>The <a href="#">continental internet registry</a> named one person to all eight board seats while withholding the vote tallies its own guidelines promised, and the <a href="#">appeal court set aside its appeal</a> for want of corporate authority.</p> <p>The appeal court had directed in October 2024 that the board be reconstituted within two months, describing it as a matter of utmost urgency, in substitution for the six months ordered in 2023 (judgment).</p> <p>The registry named a person to all eight seats in September 2025, some nine months past that deadline, while withholding every candidate vote tally its own election guidelines promised (election).</p> <p>The appeal court then set aside the registry's 2023 appeal for lack of corporate authority without ruling on the official receiver's permission or on statutory leave, leaving the authority chain from election through appointment to quorum unresolved and the receiver undischarged (appeal).</p> | REGRESSED<br>the continental internet registry seated here left with an unresolved authority chain and an undischarged receiver |
| Morocco    | <p>Host-country agreements were approved for a <a href="#">continental development agency office</a> and a <a href="#">regional cyber-incident centre</a>, and the country joined a <a href="#">cross-border rails pilot</a>.</p> <p>Both host-country agreements were approved by the council of ministers on 9 April 2026; the development agency office is not on record as established, and the cyber-incident coordination centre has no site, budget, staffing or opening date (office, centre).</p> <p>Morocco was selected in May 2026 as one of the first three countries to implement shared cross-border rails for identity, payments and trusted data exchange, on a two-stage assessment of political commitment, regulatory alignment, technical capacity, private-sector engagement and the maturity of national digital systems; no Moroccan implementation plan, budget or timetable is published (pilot).</p>                                                                        | MOVEMENT                                                                                                                        |

| COUNTRY               | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | PROGRESS                                                                                                                               |
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| Mozambique            | <p>A <a href="#">cross-border fibre interconnector</a> to Zambia was commissioned in February 2026, and a <a href="#">Nacala to Lobito submarine cable</a> is in design.</p> <p>The interconnector links Zambia's national backbone to Mozambique's submarine cable network and was commissioned in February 2026; no capacity, cost or traffic figure is stated by either government (interconnector).</p> <p>The President stated that a Nacala to Lobito submarine cable is in the design phase; the only held statement on the project is one sentence in that speech, with no route length, cost, financier or in-service date (cable).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT                                                                                                                               |
| Namibia               | <p>A <a href="#">master service agreement</a> with two Angolan counterparts commits <a href="#">1.0 Tbps of dedicated capacity</a>, and a <a href="#">satellite pilot</a> is running.</p> <p>The agreement was signed in June 2026 by the state fixed operator with two Angolan counterparts, with the Namibian operator as landing party hosting Angolan equipment, covering design, integration, testing, commissioning and handover; it builds on a memorandum and commercial terms agreed in April 2026 (agreement, deals).</p> <p>Initial dedicated transmission capacity on the subsea system is fixed at 1.0 Tbps by that agreement, as stated by the parties, with no delivered figure held (capacity).</p> <p>A pilot commercial agreement between the state fixed operator and Angola's space agency is running, with full commercial launch targeted after the pilot (pilot).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT                                                                                                                               |
| Niger                 | <p>Three strategic trans-Saharan projects were discussed at the highest level, with the two capitals reaffirming their commitment to realising them (<a href="#">report</a>).</p> <p>Three strategic trans-Saharan projects were discussed at the highest level, with the two capitals reaffirming their commitment to realising them (report). No timetable or financing is stated.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT                                                                                                                               |
| Nigeria               | <p>The country is one of three first pilots for <a href="#">shared cross-border identity, payment and data rails</a>, and a <a href="#">subsea cable to Equatorial Guinea</a> bundles a data centre with it.</p> <p>The country implementation forum for the cross-border rails pilot was inaugurated in Abuja in July 2026 (pilot, selection).</p> <p>The cable agreement was signed in February 2026 and bundles a commercial data centre, so local hosting rides in on the cross-border link (cable, account).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT                                                                                                                               |
| Rwanda                | <p>A <a href="#">cross-border digital identity pilot</a> runs with two other states, a <a href="#">terrestrial fibre route</a> was switched on in February 2026, and a <a href="#">regional satellite study</a> opened a joint funding account.</p> <p>The identity pilot runs through a continental alliance with German development cooperation, and no scale, service, date or governing instrument is stated (pilot).</p> <p>The fibre route was reported switched on in February 2026; the account is a vendor press release republished verbatim with no independent confirmation the route is live, and the corridor length and network footprint are the operator's own (route, forum).</p> <p>Partner states opened a joint funding account for a communications satellite feasibility study with deposits due 30 September 2026, and neither the study's cost nor each state's share was disclosed (study).</p> <p>The 2,000-kilometre Goma-to-Mombasa terrestrial route through Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi was announced live and carrying traffic on 9 September 2026, with access to subsea capacity at Mombasa (route).</p> | MOVEMENT                                                                                                                               |
| Sao Tome and Principe | <p>The country's stake in the <a href="#">regional submarine cable</a> was financed and built through a shared vehicle in 2015; the <a href="#">inter-island cable</a> has since cut its project rating on procurement delays.</p> <p>A grant of US\$14.9 million equivalent financed the country's contribution to the regional optical fibre cable on an open-access basis, structured through a special purpose vehicle into which government and operator contributions were made as a long-term shareholder loan (completion report).</p> <p>The national instrument behind it put a second telecommunications licence and the state's holding in the vehicle to public tender together (tender decree).</p> <p>In October 2025 the lender cut its rating for the digital project's development objective from satisfactory to moderately satisfactory on ongoing challenges with procurement of the cable to the second island, while most other activities progressed (status report). The regional cable is in service and the domestic leg to the smaller island is not.</p>                                                      | MIXED<br>the regional cable was financed and built a decade ago while the inter-island cable it should feed has slipped on procurement |
| Senegal               | <p><a href="#">Free roaming with Togo and Benin</a> took effect in April 2026, implementing a regional regulation adopted in December 2017.</p> <p>It took effect at Lomé on 24 April 2026 (roaming).</p> <p>The regulation behind it was adopted in December 2017 and applied only now, which is the finding: the instrument was not the constraint, and nothing on file says what was.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT                                                                                                                               |

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | PROGRESS |
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| Seychelles   | <p>A <a href="#">digital-trade hub memorandum</a> was signed with the continental trade secretariat and a technology partner, and its terms are not held.</p> <p>The signing was reported during the secretary-general's visit in March 2026, positioning the country as a digital-trade hub (memorandum).</p> <p>A separate claim that a digital trade corridor headquarters sits in the capital is not established and is not conflated with the memorandum here.</p> <p>No value, term, workplan or infrastructure commitment is published, so what a digital-trade hub would consist of is unstated.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT |
| Sierra Leone | <p><a href="#">Free roaming with two neighbours</a> took effect in May 2025, a <a href="#">third agreement was signed</a> in November 2025, and <a href="#">networks were interconnected at the Guinea border</a>.</p> <p>The three-country free roaming took effect on 2 May 2025 (roaming), and a further agreement with a fourth neighbour was signed at a regional summit in November 2025 and remains planned (agreement).</p> <p>Networks were interconnected at the Pamelap border in June 2025 (interconnection).</p> <p>That border link is also where the country's search for cable redundancy runs: it has one landing station on record and is seeking a second route through the same neighbour.</p>                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT |
| Somalia      | <p>A <a href="#">binding grant agreement of SDR 59.5 million</a> funds cross-border links and national backbone, and operators were <a href="#">consulted on regional roaming</a> in September 2025.</p> <p>The financing agreement signed on 21 June 2023 is the operative instrument for participation in cross-border terrestrial links, national backbone, regional exchange-point support and coordinated spectrum and cybersecurity platforms (agreement).</p> <p>The regulator convened licensed operators in September 2025 to review a national roadmap for joining the regional One Network Area, setting phased alignment of national law and tariffs with regional standards (consultation).</p> <p>Both are commitments to build rather than infrastructure in service; the feasibility study designing the routes only launched in October 2025.</p> | MOVEMENT |
| South Africa | <p>The <a href="#">regional real-time settlement system added the kwanza</a> on 27 July 2026, its first currency beyond the rand since 2013.</p> <p>2026-07-27 — the Southern African regional real-time gross settlement system added the Angolan kwanza. The system had settled in rand alone since 2013, so this is the first widening of the settlement currency in thirteen years.</p> <p>What the base does not hold is what it is worth: no volume, value, participant count or corridor breakdown is published for the system before or after the addition, so the direction is clear and the size of the step is not.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT |
| South Sudan  | <p>A <a href="#">cross-border digital connectivity memorandum with a neighbour</a> is recorded as delivered, and a <a href="#">regional satellite feasibility study</a> opened a joint funding account.</p> <p>The memorandum is recorded as delivered in the regional project's implementation report, and the signing date is not stated in it (memorandum).</p> <p>Partner states opened a joint funding account for a communications satellite feasibility study with deposits due 30 September 2026; neither the study's cost nor each state's share was disclosed (study).</p> <p>The country's fibre backbone runs through the same neighbour, so the memorandum is the legal frame under which its international capacity will arrive.</p>                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT |
| Sudan        | <p>The <a href="#">Horizon Fiber tripartite agreement</a> became binding in February 2026; a longer <a href="#">Port Sudan to Douala corridor</a> remains at pre-feasibility.</p> <p>Three operators signed a binding tripartite agreement on 4 February 2026 for a multi-terabit terrestrial fibre corridor running from Djibouti's submarine landing stations through Ethiopia to Sudan, converting a December 2024 memorandum into a commitment (agreement).</p> <p>The continental programme's record for the Sudan section of a Port Sudan to Douala corridor positions Sudan as a transit route with open-access gateways for landlocked neighbours, at planning stage (record).</p> <p>One has a signature behind it and the other does not.</p>                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT |



| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | PROGRESS |
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| Tanzania | <p>A <a href="#">twenty-year Zanzibar broadband agreement</a> was signed, ten months after the <a href="#">same agency signed an unpriced memorandum</a> with another operator that produced nothing on file.</p> <p>Nothing is on record being built under the twenty-year agreement and no first-phase start date is held (agreement, memorandum).</p> <p>The earlier memorandum covered broadband, digital inclusion and public services and produced nothing on file (earlier).</p> <p>One agency, two operators, one priced and one not, and no build under either – which is why the priced agreement is recorded as planned rather than as delivery.</p> <p>The foreign minister said in September 2026 that the two countries would fast-track a fibre-optic cable from Kigoma to Kalemie in the Democratic Republic of Congo through Lake Tanganyika, alongside a railway link through Burundi and a joint economic commission. No route survey, cost, financing or delivery date is published.</p>                                                                                           | MOVEMENT |
| Togo     | <p>A <a href="#">free-roaming arrangement with two neighbours</a> took effect in April 2026, about four months late against the regional deadline.</p> <p>It was signed at the capital and took effect on 24 April 2026 under a regional regulation of December 2017 (roaming, borders, strategy).</p> <p>No traffic or price effect has been published. A regulation adopted in 2017 and applied in 2026 is the measure of how long regional harmonisation takes to reach a subscriber here.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT |
| Tunisia  | <p><a href="#">The Marseille to Bizerte cable segment reached service in June 2026</a>, co-financed 30 per cent by the European connecting facility.</p> <p>The Marseille to Bizerte segment of the Medusa cable reached ready-for-service status on 3 June 2026, moving the country's participation in the European-backed regional system from a physical landing to operational, traffic-carrying capacity; the segment is co-financed 30 per cent by the European connecting facility's digital programme.</p> <p>It entered commercial service on 24 June with four fibre pairs at 24 Tbps each.</p> <p>This is the base's only operating shared regional infrastructure. Nothing held records a Maghreb or Arab regional network, exchange or data facility Tunisia is party to.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT |
| Uganda   | <p>The <a href="#">regional payment masterplan was approved by central bank governors in May 2025</a>, and four states <a href="#">signed a resolution for a jointly owned satellite</a> in April 2026.</p> <p>2025-05 - the Cross-Border Payment System Masterplan was approved by the partner states' central bank governors at the 28th ordinary meeting of the Monetary Affairs Committee, on four pillars covering regulatory harmonisation, payment-system modernisation including a regional instant retail switch, market deepening and capacity building, with the regional digital integration project supporting implementation.</p> <p>2026-04 - ICT ministers from four states signed a resolution to undertake a feasibility study for a regionally owned communication and broadcasting satellite at a meeting Uganda chaired in Nairobi.</p> <p>Both are approvals of intent rather than infrastructure in service: no cost, timetable or completion date is on record for the satellite study, and no Ugandan implementation step under the masterplan is stated in what is held.</p> | MOVEMENT |
| Zambia   | <p>A <a href="#">regional programme steering committee</a> convened in the capital, the programme's stated policy and oversight body held by a regional body rather than by member states.</p> <p>The third steering committee convened in July 2026, alongside the programme's annual digital forum (committee, forum, appraisal).</p> <p>Policy and oversight for a national digital programme sitting with a regional secretariat rather than with member states is a governance arrangement the record states and nowhere explains.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT |
| Zimbabwe | <p>Zimbabwe implements two COMESA trade platforms and switched on the first phase of a <a href="#">cross-border fibre corridor</a> in July 2026.</p> <p>COMESA's own account at April 2026 puts Zimbabwe among five member states implementing the electronic certificate of origin launched in November 2024, and among fifteen implementing the electronic single window, which takes trade documentation through one platform rather than several agencies (COMESA).</p> <p>The Plumtree to Bulawayo phase of a Botswana-Zimbabwe-Zambia fibre corridor went live in July 2026, the state fixed operator and its partner reporting 800 Gbps of equipped capacity (corridor).</p> <p>The SADC cluster ministerial Zimbabwe hosted in June 2026 called for improved cross-border connectivity and resilient early-warning systems, without naming a Zimbabwean commitment (ministerial).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT |

## Cross-border data transfers

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | PROGRESS |
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| Algeria  | <p>The <a href="#">2018 law's prior-authorisation and adequacy regime</a> was carried into the <a href="#">amending law of July 2025</a>.</p> <p>The founding act created the data-protection authority and, at chapter IV and notably article 44, set the prior-authorisation and adequacy regime governing transfers abroad.</p> <p>2025-07-24 - the amending law carried the regime forward, in a gazette issue that also carries a virtual-assets amendment to the anti-money-laundering law.</p> <p>The authority's own compliance guide describes an operational portal and states that processing involving transfer requires its authorisation. No adequacy decision, authorisation count or refusal is published, so the regime's operation cannot be checked.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT |
| Benin    | <p>A cross-border digital identity pilot <a href="#">is running with two other states through the continental exchange</a>, on trust chains and verification-request processing.</p> <p>2026-08-11 — a cross-border digital identity pilot is running with Rwanda and Ghana through the continental data exchange, working through public-key trust chains, interface contracts, cross-border verification-request processing and incident response, with eighteen more countries said to be joining, following a technical mission earlier in the year. Nothing of the kind existed before. It is the only working cross-border data arrangement on this ledger, and it is a pilot: no transfer volume, no legal basis for the transfers and no published agreement appears. The domestic authorisation route reported under data exchange requires the data protection authority to clear a private body before first connection, and nothing states how that applies to a foreign one.</p> <p>2026-09-03 - the authority took its position abroad: its president told a regulators' forum in Johannesburg that trust, cooperation between regulators and coordination with financial authorities are what secure the growth of artificial intelligence and cross-border data flows. It is a set of recommendations rather than an instrument, and no bilateral or regional arrangement follows from it on the record.</p> | MOVEMENT |
| Botswana | <p>Botswana <a href="#">is one of sixteen states in a regional cross-border identity and know-your-customer framework</a>, with no national integration step, pilot or date held.</p> <p>2025-08-26 — a regional cross-border digital public infrastructure and federated know-your-customer framework was set out by the regional central bank committee, naming Botswana among sixteen participating states. No Botswana-specific integration step, pilot or date is held, and the only prior real-time cross-border verification pilot named involves two other countries.</p> <p>2026-06-15 — separately, existing agricultural systems are being assessed for integration into a regional agricultural information system at a four-day national readiness workshop, with no integration date or committed systems held.</p> <p>Both are readiness exercises. The domestic layer they would connect to is thin: there is no certificate-backed identity verification, reported under authentication, and no national data exchange appears anywhere on this ledger.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT |
| Burundi  | <p>A regional secure data-sharing framework <a href="#">was validated in June 2026</a> under the East Africa digital integration project, with no national implementing instrument.</p> <p>2026-06-25 — an East African cross-border secure data-sharing framework was validated under the regional digital integration project, where none existed before.</p> <p>No national implementing instrument is on file. The domestic law that would carry it is four months older — the January 2026 data protection statute — and its supervisory authority is not operating, so the country has agreed a regional transfer framework before constituting the body that would administer transfers under it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT |
| Cameroon | <p>Central African states <a href="#">met in Douala to draft a regional framework on cross-border data flows</a>, agreeing its pillars rather than its text.</p> <p>Experts from Central African member states met in this country's second city from 31 August to 4 September 2026 to assess national readiness and agree the pillars of a regional framework governing cross-border data flows, with technical and financial support from the German development agency, a continental development agency, the Economic Commission for Africa and the African Union Commission (workshop).</p> <p>Pillars only: no draft text, adoption route, timetable or stated relationship to the continental data policy framework is published, and the base holds no national position on cross-border transfer against which to read the regional work.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT |

| COUNTRY                  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cape Verde               | <p>Transfer abroad runs on an <a href="#">adequacy test the data-protection commission decides</a>, and the commission <a href="#">signed its first bilateral supervisory memorandum, with Macau, on 1 June 2026</a>.</p> <p>The statute's article 19 makes transfer of personal data abroad conditional on the destination assuring an adequate level of protection and vests in the commission the decision whether a foreign State does so; article 20 sets the derogations under which it may permit transfer to a country without adequacy — unambiguous consent, contractual necessity, important public interest, judicial proceedings, vital interests, public register — and allows authorisation where the controller offers sufficient guarantees, expressly including adequate contractual clauses. No adequacy decision by the commission is held, so the derogations are what the base can see working.</p> <p>2026-06-01 - the commission signed in Macau a five-year renewable memorandum of cooperation with its counterpart, committing both authorities to joint training and seminars, support for investigations involving both territories, joint studies and exchange of legal interpretations and publications. It is a supervisory channel over data moving between the two jurisdictions and creates no authorisation or technical transfer mechanism.</p> | MOVEMENT                                                                                                     |
| Central African Republic | <p>The <a href="#">data protection law's chapter III sets an adequacy-based cross-border transfer regime</a>; no decision under it is held.</p> <p>The law of 25 January 2024 sets scope, principles and rights, and its chapter III sets the operative cross-border transfer regime on an adequacy basis.</p> <p>No adequacy decision, transfer authorisation, standard clause or enforcement action under it appears anywhere on this ledger, and the authority that would make one is separately on the base without a recorded decision. The regime therefore exists in law and has produced nothing that can be checked.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | NO CHANGE<br>a first stated position with no earlier account behind it                                       |
| Chad                     | <p>A <a href="#">bilateral digital-cooperation memorandum</a> was signed in Baku in January 2026 and states no data-transfer mechanism or safeguard.</p> <p>The agency's own account of the memorandum, signed on 28 January 2026 and following talks begun at a development conference in November 2025, covers electronic governance, innovation and the export of digital solutions (memorandum). It establishes a bilateral channel and states no data-transfer mechanism or safeguard, which is the finding.</p> <p>A delegation of Azerbaijani ICT experts then worked at the agency on 17 February 2026 on modernising digital infrastructure, strengthening technical and human capacity and transferring skills, ending with a visit to the national data centre (experts).</p> <p>No adequacy finding, transfer authorisation or safeguard clause for any cross-border flow involving Chad is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT                                                                                                     |
| Comoros                  | <p>Transfer abroad turns on an <a href="#">adequacy test in article 9 of the 2014 law</a>, applied by a commission that does not exist.</p> <p>Article 9 permits transfer to a foreign state only where that state assures a sufficient level of protection, judged on its rules in force, its security measures and the purpose, duration, nature, origin and destination of the data; article 43 makes such transfers subject to prior authorisation and control. No adequacy decision, authorisation or refusal is on file, which follows from the supervisory commission never having been constituted.</p> <p>2026-06 - a digital-cooperation memorandum with Bahrain's e-government authority covers advisory expertise, training, official visits and the sharing of studies and statistics; it authorises no transfer of personal or government data.</p> <p>The data governance strategy validated in August 2026 is not published, so what it says on transfers is not knowable.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | NO CHANGE<br>the 2014 adequacy test unchanged and the one new instrument covering expertise rather than data |
| Congo                    | <p>A <a href="#">twenty-year continental customs digitalisation concession was signed at Abuja</a>, covering 50 African countries.</p> <p>2026-08 - a twenty-year, US\$3.1bn concession was signed to digitalise customs procedures across 50 African countries, harmonising border formalities and enabling real-time cargo tracking, following an earlier-August memorandum at Lagos.</p> <p>It is a continental secretariat instrument the country sits inside as a state party. The country-by-country schedule and the concessionaire's payment terms are not published, and no Congo-specific participation date, engagement or data-handling arrangement is stated - for an instrument that would move consignment data across fifty borders.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT                                                                                                     |

| COUNTRY           | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | PROGRESS  |
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| Cote d'Ivoire     | <p>A <a href="#">pilot exchanging transit-goods data with Mali's customs administration</a> was launched, with no completion date for full interconnection.</p> <p>2026-08-13 - Mali's customs administration presented a pilot exchanging transit-goods data between the two customs systems at a Bamako roundtable, with no completion date for full interconnection.</p> <p>The account is entirely the Malian side's; no Ivorian statement is held, and nothing states the legal basis, the data categories exchanged or the retention arrangement. It is the only bilateral data transfer on this ledger, and the base holds no general cross-border transfer rule under the 2013 data-protection law to sit it under.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT  |
| Djibouti          | <p><a href="#">Transfer rules entered force with the Digital Code in September 2025</a> and a regional pilot mechanism is <a href="#">under preparation</a>.</p> <p>The Digital Code's articles 99 to 103 control international personal-data transfers by adequacy finding or authorisation, in force from 18 September 2025 where nothing stood before.</p> <p>2025-09 - a regional integration project mission records the July 2025 ministerial call for the two regional bodies to pilot a trusted cross-border personal-data-flow mechanism within twelve months, with a technical working group on data protection and cross-border data.</p> <p>No adequacy finding, authorisation or transfer decision has been published, and the regional health data-sharing framework remains non-binding.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT  |
| DR Congo          | <p>A regional expert panel <a href="#">recommended terrestrial gateways inside the region and citizens' data kept on the continent</a>, at a session hosted in Kinshasa.</p> <p>2026-02-24 - the panel recommended that non-geostationary satellite providers establish terrestrial gateways within the region's jurisdiction, meet obligations equivalent to traditional operators and keep citizens' data on the continent.</p> <p>It is a recommendation, not an adopted instrument, and the country is the host rather than its author. No national rule on transferring personal data abroad exists on this ledger, which matters because the identity platform running here is operated under a twenty-year concession by a foreign party and no source states where its data sits.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT  |
| Egypt             | <p>Executive regulations <a href="#">set the conditions, procedures and fees for a cross-border transfer licence</a>, five years after the law provided for them.</p> <p>Cross-border transfer is governed by the 2020 personal data protection law, issued at the presidency on 13 July 2020 with entry into force three months later.</p> <p>2025-11 - the executive regulations set the conditions and procedures for a licence or permit to transfer personal data across borders, for legal and for natural persons, and the fees for it.</p> <p>Five years passed between the law and the regulations that make its transfer regime operable, and no licence, permit or refusal issued under them appears on this ledger.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT  |
| Equatorial Guinea | <p>A <a href="#">border-screening connection</a> runs at ten sites including three airports, with no traffic figure and no successor project.</p> <p>It was extended under a regional border-management project running to 2024 (connection).</p> <p>It is the only cross-border data exchange the base holds, and no data-protection arrangement, retention rule or oversight applies to it on the record, in a country whose own supervisory body was never constituted.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | NO CHANGE |
| Eswatini          | <p><a href="#">Regional transfers are permitted under conditions</a> by the Data Protection Act, while a <a href="#">United States bilateral health agreement</a> has data-sharing terms that remain unpublished.</p> <p>The Act permits transfers within the regional bloc under conditions, which is an adequacy model written into the statute (bloc).</p> <p>The health memorandum was announced in August 2026. A federal complaint records that the State Department entered into dozens of such bilateral agreements between December 2025 and February 2026, each typically a memorandum plus at least one further data-sharing agreement, that a freedom-of-information request of December 2025 covers this country's agreements, and that the department published a subset of the memoranda in March 2026 and then withdrew public access. The data-sharing terms remain unpublished (agreement).</p> <p>So the statute governs regional transfers on published conditions and the largest bilateral transfer arrangement runs on terms nobody outside the parties can read.</p> <p>A regional federated know-your-customer layer is being funded: technical assistance was announced in August 2025 to connect national digital identity systems across 16 member states over the existing regional settlement and immediate-clearing payment systems (framework). The announcement is the implementing partners' rather than the regional secretariat's, and names no Eswatini commitment, date or instrument.</p> | MOVEMENT  |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS  |
|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Ethiopia | <p>A bilateral health memorandum <a href="#">provides for a data-sharing arrangement</a> still to be negotiated, expected to run two years beyond its five-year term.</p> <p>Clause 2.5.2 of the December 2025 memorandum has the two governments intending to negotiate an arrangement for exchanging data on long-term performance and for accountability to the United States Congress, and clause 4.7 makes failure to fulfil the specimen and data sharing arrangements grounds for changing or discontinuing assistance, although the memorandum creates no specimen arrangement (memorandum).</p> <p>A rights organisation reading the seven signed memoranda puts Ethiopia among five whose text requires unilateral sharing of specimens and pathogen-sequencing data, and all seven as requiring broad audit access (assessment); no arrangement text is published, and a subset posted by the State Department in March 2026 was removed (records complaint).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT  |
| Gabon    | <p>A <a href="#">regional health-data roadmap</a> was adopted in August 2026, and an airport passenger-data system <a href="#">entered its operational phase</a>.</p> <p>The roadmap for cross-border health-data sharing among nine Central African states was adopted at a Libreville workshop of 18 to 21 August 2026, setting a six-week deadline for drafting an inter-country convention and a four-week deadline for a formal sharing mechanism, to be put to the health ministers of the seven states yet to sign the protocol (roadmap).</p> <p>The advance passenger and passenger-name-record system moved into its operational phase on 14 August 2026 under the airport-security committee, with border risk-screening the stated purpose (passenger data).</p> <p>Neither the roadmap nor the draft convention is published, and the convention terms, the retention rule for passenger data and any authorisation by the data-protection authority are not held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT  |
| Gambia   | <p>A <a href="#">three-month customs roadmap with Senegal</a> was agreed in July 2026 to exchange customs data by interface across three border posts.</p> <p>The roadmap installs a shared customs system at Karang, Keur Ayib and Selety within three months, deploys transit tracking, exchanges customs data by interface once the system is live, replaces transit agents with a single administrative document and reactivates an intelligence platform (roadmap).</p> <p>It is the only cross-border data-sharing arrangement in the base, and no data-protection provision, retention rule or custodian is stated for the customs data it would exchange.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT  |
| Ghana    | <p>A <a href="#">United States health data-sharing agreement</a> was <a href="#">refused</a> in April 2026, and the medical regulator is pressing for an African verification exchange.</p> <p>On the data-protection regulator's account the five-year agreement covered not only health data sets but metadata, dashboards, reporting tools, data models and data dictionaries, gave ten United States entities access requiring no prior Ghanaian approval, required 25 years of citizens' health records, and settled disputes under United States law against US\$109m subject to congressional appropriation (refusal).</p> <p>The terms are the regulator's executive director quoted by a state news agency rather than a published text, and a further reported demand to integrate the national identity database with American systems in real time is attributed to another agency citing unnamed sources.</p> <p>In the other direction the medical and dental council is pressing African health regulators for shared infrastructure to verify qualifications, licence status and disciplinary records of health workers moving across borders; nothing is built (proposal).</p> | MOVEMENT  |
| Guinea   | <p>Traveller biometrics <a href="#">synchronise outward with INTERPOL, IOM and United States customs systems</a> from a border system donated in 2024.</p> <p>A secure personal identification comparison and evaluation system was inaugurated at the international airport in Conakry on 22 November 2024, a United States embassy donation, and it synchronises watchlist and immigration data with the IOM's MIDAS, INTERPOL and the United States automated targeting system (inauguration).</p> <p>The same embassy approved US\$1.8m for an IOM project, launched in September 2024, to install MIDAS control terminals at six land crossings (border terminals).</p> <p>Nothing governing what leaves the country in these exchanges is held: no data-transfer agreement, adequacy finding or oversight arrangement is on the record.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | NO CHANGE |

| COUNTRY       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PROGRESS  |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Guinea-Bissau | <p>Guinea-Bissau <a href="#">became the first member state to sign the international police privileges agreement</a> and confirmed regional police data participation.</p> <p>The signature of September 2025 is the base's clearest instrument on cross-border data: a privileges and immunities agreement with the international police organisation, and confirmed participation in the West African police information system.</p> <p>The protective side is treaty-based rather than domestic: the three cybercrime conventions ratified in May 2026 and the regional supplementary act on personal data protection.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT  |
| Kenya         | <p>A <a href="#">United States health framework</a> signed in December 2025 was frozen by injunction, with a final ruling reported due at end-October 2026.</p> <p>It runs five years with US\$1,631,470,000 of planned United States support across FY2026 to FY2030 including US\$175,000,000 for health data systems (framework); the US\$2.5bn headline is that figure plus the country's own pledged increase in domestic health spending, not a competing number (framework, litigation).</p> <p>The signed text makes audit information subject to Kenyan law and to the data-protection regulator's concurrence, and makes specimen testing and data sharing subject to Kenyan law rather than the template's five-day transfer; the subsidiary data sharing agreement has not been published.</p> <p>The suspension of the data-transfer component was reversed on appeal in May 2026 (appeal). A rights organisation reading the seven signed memoranda places this country outside both the three committing to hand over data without explicit privacy safeguards and the five requiring unilateral specimen sharing (assessment).</p> <p>In the other direction the country is one of the first three selected to implement shared cross-border rails for identity, payments and trusted data exchange, chosen on political commitment, regulatory alignment, technical capacity and system maturity; no national implementation plan, budget or timetable is published (continental pilot).</p> <p>The data protection commissioner issued a guidance note on cross-border transfers in April 2026.</p> | MOVEMENT  |
| Lesotho       | <p>The only cross-border arrangement on file is the <a href="#">health data-sharing instrument</a> with the United States, whose text is withheld.</p> <p>African governments pushed back during 2026 on United States health agreements over data and power, this country's among them (reporting).</p> <p>The data-sharing agreements attached to its own agreement have not been published, and the base holds no adequacy decision, transfer safeguard or domestic authorisation covering them (complaint).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | NO CHANGE |
| Liberia       | <p>A rights organisation's reading puts the country <a href="#">among three committing to hand over any data requested</a> for an American audit without explicit privacy safeguards.</p> <p>It is also among two whose data-sharing arrangement is deferred to an unpublished appendix, and outside the five whose text requires unilateral specimen and pathogen-sequencing sharing; the signed memorandum carries no specimen clause (assessment).</p> <p>The same reading names the country as lacking a binding comprehensive data-protection law, which is what makes the audit-access provision acute. That law has since been signed, and the appendix is still unpublished.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | REGRESSED |
| Libya         | <p><a href="#">Circular 18 of 2025</a> bans all cross-border transfer of Libyan banking data outright.</p> <p>The central bank's regulation prohibits banking data leaving Libya and requires hosting inside the country certified to international security and card-industry standards, with a penalty of LYD 100,000 per breach.</p> <p>A flat prohibition is a harder rule than most transfer regimes: there is no adequacy route, no consent route and no derogation on the record. Outside banking, no general instrument governs transfers at all, the data protection law being still unenacted.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | REGRESSED |
| Madagascar    | <p>Transfers are governed by the <a href="#">2014 law</a>, whose authorising commission became effective in 2025 and whose regional context changed in June 2026.</p> <p>The statute of 2014 governs transfers of personal data abroad; article 20 makes them subject to authorisation (statute).</p> <p>The commission that would grant such authorisations was confirmed effectively established in March 2026 (report).</p> <p>Negotiations on an enhanced economic partnership agreement with the European Union concluded in June 2026 with a digital trade chapter and updated personal-data safeguards (summary). The chapter's own text is not held, and no transfer authorisation, adequacy finding or refusal has been published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT  |



| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | PROGRESS  |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Malawi     | <p>Malawi joined a five-country roadmap for customs-to-customs data exchange (<a href="#">roadmap</a>).</p> <p>Malawi joined Mozambique, South Africa, Zambia and Zimbabwe in adopting a joint roadmap and action plan for customs-to-customs data exchange at a meeting in Pretoria on 24-26 August 2026 (roadmap).</p> <p>Sections 38 to 40 of the Data Protection Act 2024 establish the cross-border transfer regime, and the authority's compliance guideline and checklist covers the obligations it puts on a controller. No adequacy decision, authorisation or refusal under it appears anywhere on file.</p> <p>2025-12 - a continental validation workshop worked on cross-border data flow frameworks at African Union level. That is drafting above the state, not ratification or transposition by it, and nothing on file records either.</p> <p>A regime whose gatekeeping step has never been exercised on the record is a rule and not yet a practice.</p>                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT  |
| Mauritania | <p>The data protection authority <a href="#">set the conditions and procedural rules for transferring personal data abroad</a>, with a list of countries treated as adequate.</p> <p>Deliberation 004/2025 is the instrument (transfers); a companion deliberation sets minimum conditions for using cloud services hosted abroad (cloud), and both were taken up again at the authority's monthly meeting of April 2026 (meeting).</p> <p>The adequate-country list itself is not published, and no authorisation, refusal or transfer volume under the regime is on the record.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT  |
| Mauritius  | <p>Transfers run under the <a href="#">2017 Act</a> and the <a href="#">Convention 108+ protocol</a> ratified in 2020; the European adequacy assessment is open.</p> <p>The Act of 2017 governs transfer abroad (Act), and the amending protocol to the Council of Europe data convention was ratified in September 2020, among the first ratifications outside Europe (ratification).</p> <p>The national data strategy of January 2026 sets cross-border flows as a workstream (strategy). Cabinet's February 2026 decisions record the social register being used for a connectivity measure rather than any transfer arrangement (Cabinet). No transfer authorisation, refusal or adequacy finding is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | NO CHANGE |
| Morocco    | <p><a href="#">Continental data-exchange guidelines</a> drafted under Moroccan chairmanship remain unpublished, a <a href="#">ledger-based pilot</a> names the country, and <a href="#">Convention 108</a> has been ratified since 2019.</p> <p>Eleven member states convened in Rabat in July 2025 to draft the continent's first cross-border data exchange guidelines under Moroccan chairmanship of the agency council, and no guidelines were on record a year later (drafting).</p> <p>Morocco is one of three pilot states for a cross-border data exchange on a distributed-ledger reference architecture owned by the continental trade secretariat, with no Moroccan implementing body, start date or budget named (pilot).</p> <p>Convention 108 was ratified during 2019; the Council of Europe's 2012 opinion named two defects in the domestic law, its exclusion of public-safety and law-enforcement processing and a definition of sensitive data omitting sexual life and criminal convictions, and the base holds no record that either was closed (opinion).</p>              | MOVEMENT  |
| Mozambique | <p>Mozambique joined a five-country roadmap for customs-to-customs data exchange (<a href="#">roadmap</a>).</p> <p>Mozambique joined Malawi, South Africa, Zambia and Zimbabwe in adopting a joint roadmap and action plan for customs-to-customs data exchange at a meeting in Pretoria on 24-26 August 2026 (roadmap).</p> <p>The agreement was signed at Washington in December 2025 and published as a treaty record (agreement).</p> <p>Specimens, sequencing data and digital sequence information are to be shared within eight working days of a request, subject to approval by the national ethics, biosafety and security authority which shall not be unreasonably withheld, with advance consent to onward sharing with United States entities on after-the-fact notice and no cap on recipients (assessment, memorandum).</p> <p>The terms are looser than a comparable country's on transfer time and tighter on consent. It is the country's only published cross-border data transfer instrument, and it runs in a jurisdiction with no data protection statute (complaint).</p> | MOVEMENT  |



| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | PROGRESS                                                                                                |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Namibia    | <p>The government rejected a United States health data and specimen sharing proposal on sovereignty grounds (<a href="#">report</a>).</p> <p>The government rejected a United States proposal to share health data and specimens, citing sovereignty (report), while funding talks ran against a deadline (report).</p> <p>The ICT minister tabled the African Union Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection in Parliament for ratification in 2018, and the Union's own status list records the ratification (tabling). The domestic statute the Convention calls for is still a Bill.</p> <p>The two ICT ministries signed a framework at Kasane in August 2026 covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, affordable connectivity and skills development, six months after the two countries' operators signed their own memorandum on cross-border connectivity (government, operators).</p> <p>Regionally the regulator sits on the communications association's legal and policy committee, with artificial intelligence on its agenda.</p> <p>Ratified without a domestic statute is the whole position: nothing on this base governs a transfer of personal data out of the country.</p> | REGRESSED                                                                                               |
| Nigeria    | <p>A <a href="#">bilateral health memorandum</a> and its <a href="#">specimen sharing agreement</a> require sharing within five days of a United States request, against <a href="#">membership of a cross-border privacy forum</a>.</p> <p>The memorandum was signed in December 2025 with planned United States support of US\$1,953,530,560 against Nigeria's US\$2,975,634,499 (memorandum); a rights organisation's reading of seven signed memoranda puts Nigeria among five whose text requires unilateral sharing of specimens and pathogen-sequencing data and among two whose data-sharing arrangement is deferred to an unpublished appendix, with all seven requiring broad audit access (memorandum, assessment, complaint). Every page is stamped not for public release.</p> <p>The specimen agreement entered force in January 2026 for a renewable five-year term, requiring sharing within five days of a request with no numerical cap on onward sharing with non-governmental United States entities (agreement).</p> <p>The country joined a global cross-border privacy rules forum in April 2025 (forum).</p>                                                                                    | MOVEMENT                                                                                                |
| Rwanda     | <p>A <a href="#">United States bilateral health agreement</a> was signed in Washington in December 2025, and the <a href="#">data-sharing arrangement under it</a> is not published.</p> <p>The agreement was signed by the foreign minister and its text republished by a public-interest organisation; it states itself to be non-binding (agreement).</p> <p>The arrangement governing data under it is not published. What the base holds is a rights organisation's reading of the signed memorandum text, so the terms on which health and specimen data would move are known only through one organisation's account of a document the parties have not released (reading).</p> <p>That is the whole of the record: a signed instrument whose operative annexe nobody outside the parties has seen.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MIXED<br>a bilateral health agreement signed while the data-sharing arrangement under it is unpublished |
| Senegal    | <p>A second monitoring committee set a <a href="#">three-month roadmap for customs data exchange with Gambia</a> on 17 July 2026, agreed at operational level rather than by treaty.</p> <p>The roadmap clock started on 17 July 2026 (roadmap).</p> <p>It was agreed between customs administrations at operational level rather than by treaty, so there is no ratified basis for the transfer of the data it would move, and the protection authority is not named in it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT                                                                                                |
| Seychelles | <p>The African Union <a href="#">urged AfCFTA parties</a> to operationalise cross-border data commitments; an <a href="#">EU agreement</a> would bar unjustified localisation.</p> <p>The Assembly's 39th Ordinary Session in February 2026 urged State Parties to operationalise digital public infrastructure commitments on cross-border data protection and transfers under the Protocol on Digital Trade (decision).</p> <p>In June 2026 the European Union and four eastern and southern African states including Seychelles concluded negotiations on an enhanced Economic Partnership Agreement carrying a binding prohibition of unjustified data-localisation requirements and a permanent ban on customs duties on electronic transmissions (agreement).</p> <p>Domestically, the Data Protection Act 2023's cross-border transfer conditions are the operative rule (regulator). Nothing records a transfer authorised, refused or notified under it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT                                                                                                |

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | PROGRESS |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Sierra Leone | <p>The <a href="#">Nigeria framework</a> names cross-border payment interoperability and GovCloud interoperability; the only binding rule is the <a href="#">regulator's approval requirement</a> for subscriber data.</p> <p>The bilateral framework of November 2025 sets cross-border payment interoperability, GovCloud interoperability and shared data governance among its objectives, on a joint working group and an action plan (communique).</p> <p>Against that, the operative domestic rule is narrow: subscriber registration information may not be transferred outside the country without the regulator's prior approval (regulations).</p> <p>No general transfer regime exists, because the data protection Bill that would create one is not enacted.</p>                                                                                  | MOVEMENT |
| Somalia      | <p>The <a href="#">2023 Act</a> prohibits transfer outside Somalia absent adequacy or a safeguard, and the <a href="#">April 2026 regulations</a> put that regime into operating detail.</p> <p>Articles 30 and 31 of the Act establish the conditional regime (Act), and Article 24 of the implementing regulations gazetted on 5 April 2026 carries it into practice alongside registration, breach notification and audit (regulations).</p> <p>The authority's registration and licensing regime, published in June 2026, is the machinery through which a safeguard would be approved (regime).</p> <p>Civil society is separately pressing for ratification of the African Union convention that would supply an external adequacy reference (position).</p>                                                                                             | MOVEMENT |
| South Africa | <p>Five southern African customs administrations adopted a joint roadmap for customs-to-customs data exchange (<a href="#">roadmap</a>).</p> <p>The customs administrations of Malawi, Mozambique, South Africa, Zambia and Zimbabwe adopted a joint roadmap and action plan for customs-to-customs data exchange at a three-day meeting in Pretoria on 24-26 August 2026, hosted by the South African Revenue Service (<a href="#">roadmap</a>).</p> <p>It supersedes the bilateral arrangement the base previously held as the only cross-border customs data link on the record.</p> <p>A roadmap is not an exchange: the base holds no connection in service, no data-sharing instrument signed and no date by which the roadmap is to be delivered.</p>                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT |
| South Sudan  | <p>Two exploratory meetings in two months - a <a href="#">central bank discussion on cross-border payments</a> and an <a href="#">IGAD steering committee hosted in Juba</a>.</p> <p>The central bank and a Kenyan development body explored a cross-border payments system among East African Community members at a Juba meeting on 19 May 2026, with no agreement signed (meeting).</p> <p>The regional body's third project steering committee, on harmonised digital policies and interoperable digital financial systems, met in Juba on 30 June and 1 July 2026 and was opened by the deputy ICT minister (committee).</p> <p>No transfer rule exists domestically to be harmonised with. The regulator's stated position, recorded separately, is that data may be held abroad.</p>                                                                    | MOVEMENT |
| Sudan        | <p>A regional consultancy on <a href="#">data hosting and cloud-market guidelines</a> was put out to tender in March 2026; no agreement governs transfers today.</p> <p>Expressions of interest were invited on 30 March 2026 for a consultancy to develop harmonised regional guidelines on infrastructure sharing, co-location, data hosting and the cloud market across member states including Sudan (notice).</p> <p>This is procurement, not policy. What the base does not hold is any instrument — regional or bilateral — that presently governs the transfer of personal or public-sector data across Sudan's borders.</p> <p>Sudan's own sectoral rules reach only as far as hosting-location disclosure in telecommunications licensing (licensing).</p>                                                                                           | MOVEMENT |
| Tanzania     | <p><a href="#">Part V of the 2022 statute</a> sets the transfer regime, and the <a href="#">eight regional states reaffirmed a shared data-governance agenda</a>.</p> <p>Part V of the 2022 data protection statute sets the substantive rules for transborder data flow, requiring an adequacy assessment and commission-authorised safeguards for transfers to states without adequate protection, with the commission itself established by section 6.</p> <p>All eight East African Community partner states reaffirmed at a project steering committee in May 2026 their commitment to inclusive regional data-governance frameworks supporting secure cross-border data flows.</p> <p>No adequacy determination for any destination country, and no authorised-transfer count, has been published; a reaffirmation of commitment is not a framework.</p> | MOVEMENT |

| COUNTRY         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS  |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Togo</b>     | <p>A <a href="#">regional dialogue on border interoperability</a> was held at a joint border post, with no data-protection arrangement stated for the shared border and transit data.</p> <p>The dialogue took place in August 2026 at a joint post on the coastal corridor (dialogue). No deployment figure, timetable or data-protection arrangement for the shared border and transit data is stated. The country has a data-protection statute and an operating authority, and neither is named in the arrangement.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT  |
| <b>Tunisia</b>  | <p><a href="#">Transfer abroad needs the data-protection authority's prior authorisation in every case</a>, from an authority that has taken no recorded action.</p> <p>Chapter IV of the 2004 organic law bars transfer abroad where it threatens public security or the country's vital interests, requires an adequate level of protection in the destination country, and requires the data-protection authority's prior authorisation in every case, to be decided within one month.</p> <p>The sponsoring deputies of a replacement bill were heard by the rights and freedoms committee on 17 February 2026; the bill names cross-border transfers among the domains the 2004 law leaves uncovered and has not passed.</p> <p>No authorisation decision, refusal, adequacy finding or transfer statistic has ever been published, so a per-transfer authorisation regime runs with nothing on the record to show it operating.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Uganda</b>   | <p>A <a href="#">data sharing agreement under the health memorandum</a> is provided for and still to be executed, alongside a specimen agreement covering genetic sequence data of high-consequence pathogens.</p> <p>The agreement is provided for at a numbered clause and is not on record as completed; a specimen sharing agreement covering genetic sequence data during an outbreak is likewise provided for, effective for no more than five years, and is likewise incomplete (agreement, memorandum, complaint).</p> <p>The country has a data-protection statute in force and a protection office issuing orders against global platforms, and neither is named in the arrangement.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT  |
| <b>Zambia</b>   | <p>Zambia joined a five-country roadmap for customs-to-customs data exchange (<a href="#">roadmap</a>).</p> <p>Zambia joined Malawi, Mozambique, South Africa and Zimbabwe in adopting a joint roadmap and action plan for customs-to-customs data exchange at a meeting in Pretoria on 24-26 August 2026 (roadmap). It is a roadmap, not a connection in service.</p> <p>The Data Protection Act, 2021 carries the cross-border data transfer regime at sections 70 and 71.</p> <p>That is the instrument. What the base does not hold is any evidence of it operating: no adequacy determination for another country, no transfer authorisation granted, no condition imposed and no enforcement action. A transfer regime that has produced no visible decision in five years tells a reader about capacity rather than about policy — and the Commissioner's own account of registration as the outstanding first step is the corroboration.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT  |
| <b>Zimbabwe</b> | <p>A <a href="#">signed guideline</a> governs personal-data transfers out of Zimbabwe, 24 had been authorised by late 2025, and a customs data exchange is agreed with three neighbours.</p> <p>Zimbabwe joined Malawi, Mozambique, South Africa and Zambia in adopting a joint roadmap and action plan for customs-to-customs data exchange at a meeting in Pretoria on 24-26 August 2026 (roadmap).</p> <p>The data protection authority's guideline CDPG 5 of 2024, signed on 13 November 2024 under sections 6(1)(a) and 28(3) of the Cyber and Data Protection Act, is the specific instrument governing transfers of personal information out of the country (guideline).</p> <p>24 cross-border personal-data transfers had been authorised under the Act by late 2025 (figure). It is the first such count the base holds, so it establishes a level rather than a direction.</p> <p>Revenue authorities from Malawi, Mozambique, Zambia and Zimbabwe renewed a commitment on 27 August 2025 in Lusaka to fast-track an integrated customs-to-customs data exchange, to speed trade and curb illicit cross-border flows (customs). No build, budget or go-live date is held.</p> | MOVEMENT  |

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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